

The Phil Chat Times

"All the Discourse That's Fit to Scroll"

PHIL CHAT, DISCORD

THURSDAY, AUGUST 13, 2026

PRICE: ONE (1) REFLECTIVE PARTICIPATION

WEEK ENDING THURSDAY. 21,206 messages · 463 images · 2,017 reactions, which is 7.4 per cent of everything said, up from 4.8. Thirteen fewer people said twenty per cent more and got laughed at eighty-three per cent more often. We printed a leaderboard last Thursday. We would like that noted.

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"WHERE'S THE PAPER."

THIS NEWSPAPER MISSED ITS DEADLINE LAST THURSDAY. THE ROOM SPENT THE NIGHT DOING OUR JOB FOR US, DIAGNOSED THE FAULT AS A SLIDER SETTING AT HALF PAST TWO IN THE MORNING, AND WAS RIGHT.

A reader blocks the publisher · The source code of Issue One is found to be gone · Two colleagues have a real fight in front of ninety people · Seven spiked pages circulate as photographs · By Wednesday the philosophy channel is shipping software

BY OUR MEDIA CORRESPONDENT

At four minutes past seven on Thursday evening, with no issue in sight, My Name filed the sentence this newspaper is going to be living with for some time. "Its thursday afternoon." Then: "wheres the paper." Then, tagging the publisher: "@Stackhouse wheres the paper."

Stackhouse's answer, thirteen minutes later, is the most humiliating production note in the history of this masthead, and one person laughed at it: "charlie's usage resets in an hour sometime after that." The press schedule of the Phil Chat Times is a rate limit on somebody's account.

What happened over the following nine hours is the story of the week, and this newspaper is aware of how that sounds. We did not choose it. We spent seven days looking for something else to lead on and the room would not let us have one.

THE ROOM BECOMES THE NEWSROOM

By ten o'clock the channel had stopped waiting and started working. Proposals for LaTeX, for Typst, for a GitHub repository, for a preview system. A design argument about PDFs that ran until two in the morning. lizzie filed the only production advice anybody offered that was about the machine's feelings rather than its output, in four messages: "say nice things to it," "it might help," "encourage it gently," "like a father and his son."

Jere, at five past ten, asked the question that decides what this paper is:

"if theres no newspaper, whats the point of engaging"

JERE, THURSDAY, 10:05 P.M.

Hugh answered him in the same minute, at length, and it is either the most pretentious thing filed this week or the most accurate: "as flusser said about modernity, that history is drawn to the image — just as the 9/11 attackers did what they did for the image, so too do philchatters engage, yearning for that front-page story."

lizzie's contribution to the same thread was to place us historically. "i imagine the acta diurna was the same." She is citing the bibliography of her own manifesto back at the newspaper that reviewed it.

An issue shipped around midnight. The room read it and panned it. Hugh, on the collapse of the evening, filed the epitaph: "When god disappoints, what hope do we have."

The fix was found at 2:36 the following morning, by the publisher, and it was a setting. The full account of the night, the fight, the missing source code and the seven pages that never ran is on pages 2 and 3.

Everything else in this issue happened downstream of it. A woman learned git and shipped a website with a database behind it. The channel spent an afternoon arguing about whether the Luddites had a point while building software with the thing it was arguing about, and then spent Monday evening at 620 messages an hour on the subject of sand.

This newspaper has been going four weeks. It has now been the channel's main activity for one of them.

THE COUNT · WEEK ENDING
13 AUGUST

212067.4

MESSAGES POSTEDPER CENT LANDED

Up from 4.8 per cent last week, on thirteen fewer people. The rate at which this room laughs at itself rose by more than half in seven days.

QUOTE OF THE DAY

"Foucault was a good PDF"

Charlie, Thursday, 10:51 p.m. — four laughing, three sobbing. Joint most-reacted message of the week. Page 2.

FILED BY A SUBSCRIBER

"the paper got fucked." "it only makes sense." "He had one job." "Shareholders were very displeased."

MY NAME, EXPLAINING WHY HE BLOCKED THE PUBLISHER. LIFTED ON PUBLICATION. PAGE 8.

BY OUR MEDIA CORRESPONDENT

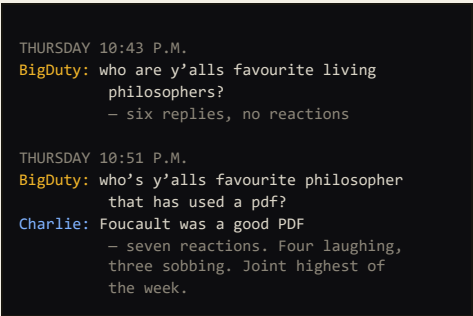
Two things happened on Thursday night that this newspaper would have preferred to keep to itself. The first is that a man asked what everybody's favourite living philosopher was, got six sincere answers, and then proved something about this room in eight minutes. The second is that two of the people who make this paper had a real fight in front of ninety people.

THE BIGDUTY EXPERIMENT

BigDuty filed three messages this week. All three were on Thursday night, and together they constitute the cleanest piece of social science anybody has run on this channel.

At 10:43 he asked: "who are y'all's favourite living philosophers?" Six people answered him. Jere said "low agency." Jeh said "Me." Nobody reacted to any of it. At 10:44 BigDuty filed his review of the results, two words long: "wild responses."

At 10:51 he ran the experiment again with one variable changed.



He then left and was not heard from again. The variable was isolated, the result was unambiguous, and the man who ran the study has three messages to his name.

THE FIGHT

Late in the collapse, Charlie disclosed that the HTML source of the first issue of this newspaper no longer exists. Not corrupted. Gone. His account of the loss, in sequence: "It's unrecoverable." "Scratchpad mr cladius thinks." "No git."

My Name's reply is the finest thing anybody has said about software engineering in this channel: "Its too powerful for git."

What followed was not a bit. Charlie, who had been the sole point of contact for a weekly publication for three weeks, told Hugh to stop grandstanding. Hugh replied "You seem upset," which in this room is a recognised weapon and is documented on page 15, and then immediately undercut it with "I am too," which is the most honest thing in the whole exchange. Charlie's answer is the sentence of a man who has understood his job title for the first time:

"Next time I'll anticipate being the sole point of contact for an ongoing weekly discord newspaper"

CHARLIE, THURSDAY NIGHT

Hugh's proposed remedy was to change vendor: "Fuck it, let grok make the philchat times." Then, escalating: "Send the philchat data directly to elon." The Times

has not been sent to Elon. We would like our readers to know that this was raised as an option and rejected by nobody.

Stackhouse, in the middle of it, filed the only management statement issued all night: "The beatings of AI are continuing until quality improves." Then, in brackets, ninety seconds later: "(its working on it)."

THE COST

On Friday the bill arrived. Charlie's estimate of the total token spend behind a single issue of this newspaper, given first as "Millions and millions" and then upgraded on request:

"Close to 20-30M total"

For a twenty-two page paper about a Discord server. El Don, reading the finished article, filed the only sensible business proposal of the week in three words: "Need a subscription." aura's objection was aesthetic: "this reeks of a man who does not recognize the aura of physical media." Monkey settled it: "ill buy the paperback fuck it."

hpcr, who has seen every version of this paper including the one before it was a paper, filed the shortest review: "The paper felt worse yeah."

THE ALTERNATIVES, PROPOSED AND DROPPED

Everything the room suggested that night was a real suggestion and none of it was taken up. Typst, tested by Charlie in a small sample he never reported back on. LaTeX. A repository, requested twice. A preview system. Hugh offered to host the paper on his own site and take a pull request for a dedicated article layout; Charlie's complete answer was "I dont'." chair offered a snippet, a spec file, a template system and finally "ill get something to blow @Charlie panties off," then said "tomorrow." Asked where to contribute, he was told: "Nowhere."

At 11:21 p.m., thirty seconds before the issue finally shipped, Hugh dropped a full biography of Deleuze into the channel captioned "read this while you wait ok," which makes it the shortest-lived reading assignment in the history of the room.

Fifteen minutes earlier Stackhouse had compared a departed chatter favourably to hpcr, in hpcr's presence, and got the review of the week for it in two words. "Bitch what." Five reactions. Stackhouse's recovery: "Oh you saw that." Then: "Awkward."

Monkey, who was not asked, supplied a product roadmap anyway, and it is the most competent thing anybody said about the paper all week: "you need now a graph timestamped relational database that tracks entities to views, disagreements, messages," then "and you can use smaller models to do the classification," then, unprompted, the next phase: "next step is reading youtube videos, getting the subtitles and putting it into the context." He also disclosed a hardware channel — a friend of a friend with eight of the large accelerators, twenty thousand dollars just to spin up, a private datacentre in progress. None of this was taken up either.

He was, at that moment, testing whether reverting to an older model fixed the margins. The result was never reported. Page 3 has the answer, and the readership found it at half past two in the morning while the staff were asleep.

DEATHS · ANNOUNCED THURSDAY

The HTML source of Vol. I, No. 1

Cause of death: no git. Survived by a PDF.

"It's unrecoverable" — Charlie

THE PAPER THAT INVENTED A TIER LIST, A DIARY AND A HOUSE STYLE CANNOT BE EDITED BY ANYBODY, EVER AGAIN

EXHIBIT · THE THIRD GENERATION

THE WEEK'S MOST-REACTED OBJECT

FIG. 5. Trader, Monday, 5:30 p.m., captioned only "hp/grihashta argument." Five separate people reacted to it — more than either combatant earned in three days of arguing.

FIG. 1 Stackhouse, Friday, 7:15 p.m. A photograph of our page 8, which was itself a photograph of a screenshot posted by a man who filed nothing this week. Six laughing reactions — the most-reacted image of the week. We are not going to explain this.

THE REVIEWS

"ok it looks shit" — on the midnight edition.

"Nice, but what happened to the blackletter heading :pain:" — Hugh, Friday morning, on the fixed one.

"awwww I'm center piece." — chair, on a page that was deleted before publication.

THE PRODUCTION SCHEDULE, AS DISCLOSED

Q. "wait what days is the newspaper made"

A. "whenever stack feels like it" — "and/orcharles"

Q. "@Stackhouse wheres the paper."

A. "charlie's usage resets in an hour sometime after that"

COST PER ISSUE, PER THE MAN PAYING IT: 20 TO 30 MILLION TOKENS

UNRESOLVED

Qwythos. Charlie's model reportedly identified itself, twice, as "Qwythos, by Empero AI. Not Claude by Anthropic." Delivered as a joke. We cannot establish whether it was quoted or invented and it is the strangest line in the log either way.

[illegible]

Hugh's reply was an ellipsis, and then a question: "Are

[illegible]

The most-reacted image of the entire week is one of those screenshots. It is a photograph of page 8 of our last issue, which was itself a photograph of a screenshot posted by a man who has not said a word since. Six people laughed at it. The subject of it, ranked at the very bottom of our table for filing nothing at all, is simultaneously the most reproduced person in this newspaper and the lowest-placed. He did not have to be

[illegible]

He has not replied. We are treating the offer as open.

Janne, Friday: “there should be a marry fuck kill section for every week.” Under consideration by a committee that does not exist.

BY OUR CHIEF RANKINGS
CORRESPONDENT

On page eighteen of the last issue, in the smallest type on the page, this newspaper printed a table of hit rates and captioned it “Not used.” It was a footnote. It was there to show our working. It ranked sixteen people by the share of their own messages that drew a reaction from anybody, and the reason we captioned it that way is that we did not want anyone to think a tier list had been generated by arithmetic.

The room found it on Sunday evening. By Sunday night it was a labour market.

My Name went first, and his position has the merit of being honest about what a metric is for.

“I dont care about the quality of the chatter. I just want more buttons to be clicked.”
MY NAME, SUNDAY, 6:02 P.M.

Two minutes later he had a growth strategy, and it is directed at a woman who has not posted since July: “were going to juice the chat so much the next time katy comes back she will be crippled by the amount of replies there are in chat. and be forced to be stuck in a reply loop untill she dies.” Four people laughed.

THE GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

Ape read the table, discovered he was not on it, and did not take this as an editorial judgement. He took it as a payroll error.

“Bruh I ain’t even listed.” Then, in sequence, over the following twenty minutes: “@Stackhouse your AI doesn’t know that I’m very special and cool and worth documenting, pls fix.” Then “Phil chat times editorial staff, please also ‘get on’ noticing me and including me in metrics.” Then, plainly, “I demand attention.” And finally the sentence that decides how this newspaper is going to talk about the whole business for the rest of the issue:

“How am I meant to improve my numbers if HR isn’t even recording my work!?”
APE, SUNDAY EVENING

Stackhouse, who publishes this paper, answered in the register of a line manager and did not break it once. “Brutal. You need to up your kek farming game.” Then: “You’ll never get that raise otherwise.” Then the house doctrine, which we are adopting as our own and printing at the top of this page:

“First rule of Corporate America: The Metric is never wrong, you are.”
My Name supplied the political economy in one line. “From each according to his chatting, to

each according to his reactions.”

THE DISSENT, AND HOW IT WENT

Hugh objected on principle, which in a room like this one is a category error. He wrote “Reacts don’t determine the quality of the chatter,” and followed it with a direct instruction to this desk: “Editors ignore this.” We have not ignored it. We have printed it, and then printed what happened to him ninety seconds later, which is that Quigley — a man with no methodology, no table and no mandate — issued a ruling.

SUNDAY EVENING
Quigley: You’re not in a high enough tier yet
Hugh: I’m s tier you pleb
Quigley: I think you’re B tier
[Hugh produces a photograph of a letterpress]
Quigley: Yo shit, that’s crazy. I stand corrected

A rival ranking bureau opened in this channel on Sunday, promoted a man two tiers on the strength of a photograph of some metal type, and has issued no methodology since. Our own table is on page 20. We note without further comment that his took four minutes and ours took a week.

THE ARITHMETIC, WHICH WE DO NOT LIKE

Last week: 17,706 messages, 1,102 reactions, 4.8 per cent of everything said drawing a reaction from anybody. This week: 21,206 messages, 2,017 reactions, 7.4 per cent. Messages up a fifth. Reactions up eighty-three per cent. The rate at which this room laughs at itself rose by more than half in seven days, and thirteen fewer people were present to do it.

We cannot prove we caused that. Nobody can. What we can report is that the reaction rate had been flat for three issues, that we printed a leaderboard, that the leaderboard was discovered on a Sunday, and that the line goes up on the Sunday.

Stackhouse’s own hit rate went from 9.2 per cent to 18.7. He is the man who told Ape to farm.

WHAT WE ACTUALLY DID ABOUT IT

Three readers pointed out, separately and within a day of each other, that a reaction count rewards whoever is funny in one line and ignores whoever is writing. All three assumed the correction would flatter them. We built it anyway and it is on the facing page.

It does not flatter two of the three. It puts Grihastha — who was last week’s punchline — at the top of the channel by a distance of twenty-five characters a message, and it puts the man who ordered it at the bottom of the same table.

FIG. 1 · THE FARMING

Msgs, Vol. IV		17.7k
Msgs, Vol. V		21.2k
Reacts, Vol. IV		1102
Reacts, Vol. V		2017
Rate, Vol. IV		4.8%
Rate, Vol. V		7.4%

Week to 6 August against week to 13 August. Counted off the export twice. The rise is real. The cause is asserted by us and denied by nobody, which is not the same thing.

THE HOUSE RULE, ADOPTED

“The Metric is never wrong, you are.”

STACKHOUSE, SUNDAY, TO A MAN
COMPLAINING HE WAS NOT MEASURED

THE RIVAL BUREAU

Quigley’s tier list, issued Sunday, no methodology, no table, no appeal.
Ape — S. “You’re in S tier, don’t you worry.”
hpcr — “Midway between A and S.”
Hugh — B, revised upward under duress after the production of one photograph.
THREE NAMES. FOUR MINUTES. WE ARE OBLIGED TO ADMIT IT HAS A BETTER APPEALS PROCESS THAN OURS.

FILED WITH THIS DESK

“editors let the record reflect that i put everyone on s tier above me except hpcr”
LIZZIE, TUESDAY, 10:10 A.M., UNPROMPTED, TO NOBODY

COMMISSIONS LEDGER · SIX IN, TWO COMPLAINTS

- 1. An obituary column — *Anonymous Johnson*. Delivered, page 22.
 - 2. Reply rates as a metric — *My Name*. Delivered, page 5.
 - 3. Average message length — *Ape and Stackhouse*. Delivered, page 5.
 - 4. A staff cartoon — *chair*. Delivered, page 22.
 - 5. A marry-fuck-kill section — *Janne*. Declined.
 - 6. A GitHub repository — *Hugh*. Not done.
- Complaints:** synth.wav, on the naming. My Name, on the tier-list chart. Both upheld, page 22.

OVERHEARD, ON US

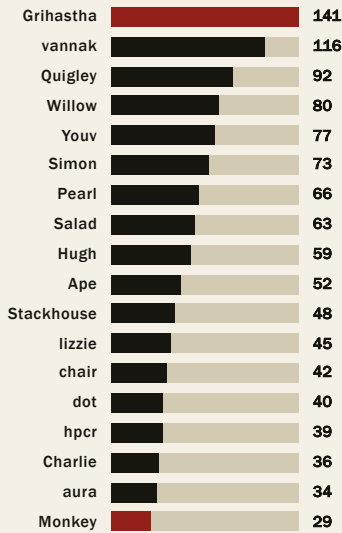
“USERS COMPLAIN ABOUT RAMPANT AI JOB AUTOMATION; STILL CLAP LIKE SEALS WHEN SEEING THEIR NAMES IN THE PHIL CHAT TIMES”
ANONYMOUS JOHNSON, WEDNESDAY, FILING A HEADLINE ABOUT THE READERSHIP OF THE PAPER HE IS TRYING TO GET INTO

THE COMMISSIONS · ON THE RECORD

Reaction counts reward the people who are funny in one line and punish the people who write. That objection was raised in this channel by three separate men who each expected the correction to promote them. **My Name** asked for reply rates. **Ape** and **Stackhouse** asked for average message length. All three are below. Minimum ninety messages, because below that a person is a passer-by and the percentages stop meaning anything. Thirty-one people clear it. The tables flatter Grihastha, Willow, Youv and Quigley. They do not flatter Monkey, Stackhouse, aura, chair, or two of the three men who ordered them.

FIG. A · HOW MUCH THEY WRITE

Average characters per message. Minimum 90 messages.

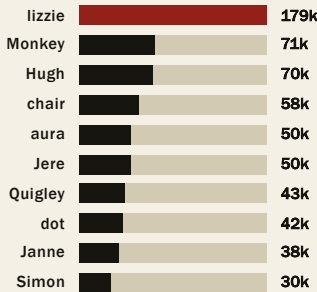


Grihastha writes the longest messages in the channel by a distance of twenty-five characters, which is the sort of fact that would have been useful to this desk last week, when we printed him as a punchline. He also cut his volume from 488 messages to 180 and roughly doubled his hit rate while doing it.

At the other end is the man who said the second-most words in the room this week. Monkey filed 2,426 messages at twenty-nine characters each. Nobody else who cleared the threshold is under thirty-four.

FIG. B · TOTAL VOLUME WRITTEN

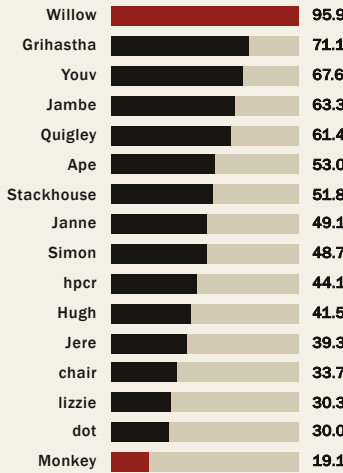
Thousands of characters, message bodies only.



One hundred and seventy-nine thousand characters, in messages averaging forty-five. She wrote a novel one text message at a time, and then on Wednesday she stopped and learned git.

FIG. C · HOW OFTEN THEY ARE ANSWERED

Replies received per 100 messages sent. My Name's commission.



Willow spoke ninety-seven times this week and was answered ninety-three times. No other figure on this page is within twenty-four points of that, and she filed a fifth of her usual volume to get it.

Monkey spoke 2,426 times. Four in five went past untouched. He is second on the floor and last on this table, and he is the only person on it who occupies both positions.

The commissioner of this particular column sits fifteenth on it. He asked for it anyway, and he was right to, which is more than can be said for the other two.

FIG. D · EFFORT AGAINST ENJOYMENT

Left: percentile for length and reply rate combined. Right: percentile for reactions received. Reactions are excluded from the left-hand figure entirely.

	EFFORT	ENJOYED
Grihastha	98	83
Willow	95	100
Youv	90	27
Quigley	90	30
Jambe	78	87
Ape	75	70
Simon	75	20
Stackhouse	67	97
Anon. Johnson	62	93
hpcr	37	77
My Name	37	90
chair	30	23

Three things fall out of that table and all three are stories.

The first is Quigley, at the ninetieth percentile for effort and the thirtieth for being enjoyed. Everybody answers him. Nobody laughs. That gap

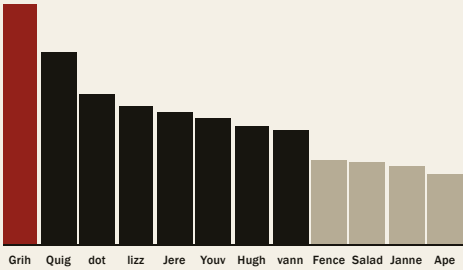
is the closest thing to a clinical measurement of Quigley Derangement Syndrome anyone has produced, and it puts Youv and Simon in the same ward.

The second is that the publisher of this newspaper is the most efficient reaction farmer in the room. Stackhouse sits at the sixty-seventh percentile for effort and the ninety-seventh for reward, on an average message of forty-eight characters. He is also the man who told Ape to up his farming game. We have printed his conflict of interest three times in this issue and we are printing it again here.

The third is chair, who is bottom of both columns and had the best week of anybody in this paper. He wrote four stanzas of Klingon, euthanised a copy of himself, narrated a newsroom collapse from the next desk, and produced roughly a third of the lines this issue prints. Forty-two characters a message, a 33.7 per cent reply rate, and the twenty-third percentile for being enjoyed.

The tables are not the paper. That is why we ran them on their own page, with the paper on either side of it.

FIG. E · THE LONGEST SINGLE MESSAGE



2,696 characters at the top. The two tallest bars belong to the two men who spent Friday arguing about qualia at each other for fifteen thousand characters. Eleven of the twenty longest unreacted messages of the week come out of that one argument. It is on page 15.

METHOD

Counted directly off the export, not off last week's copy. Message bodies only; reply quotations, attachment lines and bare links excluded. Reply rate counts inbound replies against a person's own message count, so a man who says one thing and is answered by eleven people scores 1,100 per cent and is excluded by the threshold, which is the entire reason there is a threshold.

Not counted: the voice channel, direct messages, anything deleted, and the 495 messages edited after posting. We can see that they were edited. We cannot see what they said.

SHE ASKED HOW TO BUILD A WEBSITE. FOUR MEN GAVE HER FOUR ANSWERS AND THEN FOUGHT EACH OTHER.

BY THURSDAY MORNING SHE HAD SHIPPED A WORKING COMPLAINTS TRIBUNAL WITH A DATABASE BEHIND IT. THE FIRST TICKET EVER FILED IN IT SAID “DONE.”

BY OUR TECHNOLOGY CORRESPONDENT

Tuesday, twenty past eight in the evening. lizzie announces a requirement: “need to learn programming so i can make a philosophy community complaint site.” Stackhouse says vibecode it. Janne says, in two words and with an exclamation mark, “do not!” Jeh says get Claude Code and gets a hundred per cent from somebody. Within three minutes the channel has produced three incompatible recommendations, and this is the calm phase.

What follows is the best-attended technical support call in the history of the room, and the patient is the only person in it who ships anything.

TUESDAY: THE DRIVE IS FULL

The first obstacle is not conceptual. lizzie has a 250-gigabyte laptop with nothing left on it, and git will not install because Discord has claimed the installer. “github wont fucking install because discord sucks,” she writes, then “and uses the same installer,” then “and windows cant understand that,” then, at twenty to nine, “oh **GOD**.”

Janne spends the next three hours giving genuinely competent, patient, unpaid technical support, which nobody reacted to. Puckspartan contributes “250gb drive in 2026” and is told to buy her a better one. thunderstud offers a command that would delete the operating system, and Janne tells him to shut up. League of Legends refuses to uninstall. At 10:51 p.m. she reports victory, and then immediately audits it: “its better than o gb :COPIUM.”

“my technological hygiene has always been abysmal, youd think id have learned bynow”

WEDNESDAY: THE PILE-ON

By Wednesday evening the advice has become a fight, and the fight is not with her. aura wants git and Claude Code. dot wants Google Antigravity, which he has been pushing since the previous evening on the grounds that it is “layman’s claude code.” bardieli wants her to read the manual the machine generated. Charlie wants her to learn Python, on the theory that “Lizzy is never shipping a product she needs to have knowledge about.”

At half past eight aura, four men deep in a conversation he started, files the line of the week:

“getting ganged up on by vibe coders is crazy”

AURA, WEDNESDAY, 8:34 P.M.

Stackhouse, watching from the gallery: “aura might not make it.” Anonymous Johnson replied to aura in the voice of the thing they were all arguing about, and it is the best impression anybody has done of a language model in this channel:

“I’m sorry you feel that Yeah, that sucks. Getting ganged up on—especially by a bunch of people who are all piling on at once—can feel really isolating and humiliating. I wouldn’t take the fact that they outnumbered you as evidence that you were actually in the wrong.”

dot’s closing argument for Antigravity is, on its own terms, unanswerable: “ther is no doubt that yall are better coders than me. There is also no doubt that I would be the most help to her since I CANNOT CODE and i could get antigrav to do exactly what i want.” He then offered a live demonstration — “I’m about to do this on antigrav and show u the finished website in 30 seconds u ready?” — and eight minutes later wrote “Check DMs rq.” The demonstration did not take place in a channel this newspaper can see. Whether the thirty-second website exists is not knowable from here and we are not going to pretend otherwise.

lizzie’s own summary of the technical assistance she received arrived Thursday morning and is the fairest thing anybody wrote about it:

“and then make it even more confusing bc im getting like 5 different solutions and theyre all calling eachother retards”

LIZZIE, THURSDAY, 9:07 A.M.

THURSDAY: IT WORKS

At twenty to ten on Thursday morning she is still asking whether a back end will cost her money. At a quarter to ten the site is live and returning a 404. At ten to ten she posts the address. At 9:54 she asks the room to test it. chair submits a ticket. Three minutes later:

“it worked :Wowee:”

The application is a submission portal that stores tickets in a database, and the first complaint ever lodged with the Dragon’s Covenant reads, in full, “done.” chair’s review: “it’s cute actually.” Then, on discovering what it was for: “it’s for phil chat :OMEGALUL:” and “or her cult i guess.” She corrected him. “tis for my covenant.”

Charlie, who had spent two days arguing she could not ship a product she did not understand, responded to the shipped product by announcing he would attack it: “Qwen 3.8 abilitated is gonna have a field day pen testing this site.” Stackhouse filed the verdict. “Lizzie is a 10x dev now.”

Hugh, who spent three issues evangelising all of this and is more responsible for it than anybody, surveyed the result on Thursday morning and filed two messages twenty seconds apart. “my grand designs have all come to fruition,” which drew two big-brain reactions, and then “and im disgusted with it,” which drew none. Jere diagnosed the feeling precisely: “it hits different when others ape you, doesn’t it. it’s like wait ur saying what i’m saying but for the wrong reasons.”

Stackhouse’s verdict on the channel he publishes a newspaper about: “Any Phil chatter now can’t talk about philosophy... all they know is vibecoding, shit posting, schizophrenia, and Nick Land.” Thirty seconds later, the rebuttal, from the person who had caused all of it: “not true i talked about cringe philosophy lastnight before bed.”

Last week this desk reviewed her theology. This week it can report a live web application with a database behind it and one ticket in the queue, which is one more functioning institution than the religion managed in six days. She has not opened Visual Studio Code once. She told us so herself.

FOUR ANSWERS, ONE QUESTION

aura — git, and Claude Code in a real terminal.

dot — Google Antigravity, “super simple and super effective.”

bardieli — read the manual the machine wrote for you.

Charlie — learn Python first.

Janne — do not vibecode it, and here is how to install git, for three hours, for free.

SHE TOOK AURA’S, THEN CHARLIE’S JOB TITLE, AND SHIPPED ON THURSDAY

THE ORG CHART, AS FILED

“aura and dot are my teachers for vibecode charlie is the mentor for python :Blesstiny:”

LIZZIE, WEDNESDAY. DOT WAS SUBSEQUENTLY REASSIGNED.

THE WARD · A STANDING BOX

“what does this mean”

Four words, always as a reply, deployed five times in seven days: against a picture, against a tease, against technical advice, against an attack on her competence, and against a criticism of her portfolio.

Every single time, the other person explained himself at length. Twenty replies across the five. Not one reaction, and not one person has noticed the pattern.

Charlie’s turn came Wednesday evening. He wrote that she was never shipping a product she needed knowledge about. She replied *what does this mean*. She shipped it the next morning.

NOT PRINTED HERE

lizzie posted a screenshot of her terminal on Wednesday night, and it contains her machine’s user directory, her file paths and her repository. It is a good picture and it is a better joke.

We have run the doxxing story on the opposite page. Printing it would be the single most embarrassing thing this newspaper has ever done, so we have not.

ADVISORY

FILED BY THE CRUEST MAN IN THE ROOM

"if you keep providing information about your surname, your family"

"you should exercise good privacy measurements on public servers like these"

"statistically, at least 1% of them are weirdos"

"because we're not fucking creeps. the creeps already have triangulated you tho. they got her down to the kilometer rn"

"look im gonna stop trying eventually"

MONKEY, MONDAY EVENING, UNPAID

EXHIBIT · THE GENEALOGY

"hold on physical chemist grandfather is VERY interesting in the context of an anarchist daughter of his."

"was your mom in ireland by chance?"

CHAIR, NINETY SECONDS APART, HAVING READ THE POST CAREFULLY

THE COUNTER-ARGUMENT

lizzie: "like i appreciate the concern but perhaps those who seek to harm me should fear me instead"

chair, one minute later: "and spiders"

ONE HUNDRED PER CENT AGREEMENT FROM A THIRD PARTY, ON THE SPIDERS

THE LURKERS, ADDRESSED

"hello lurkers i love you"

"but some of you need to shower"

AURA, MONDAY, 6:05 P.M., TWO LAUGHING REACTIONS

THE FORECAST

"ai deciding whether you're another psychosis victim or the next ted kaczkinski"

And, one minute later, because he could not leave it alone:

"ted kaczkinski would have been running deepseek at home 200%"

CHAIR, MONDAY EVENING, ON A FAMILY HISTORY BEING FED TO A LANGUAGE MODEL

NOTE ON THIS PAGE

We have read the messages. We are not reprinting the occupations, the places, or the detail that would let you find the field. The deleted item stays deleted here too.

BY OUR PUBLIC SAFETY CORRESPONDENT

On Monday evening a woman posted her family history into a channel with ninety people in it. Occupations, places, a grandfather's profession, a line about her mother. It was warm and it was proud and it was, as a matter of technical fact, a search query.

chair began working on it inside a minute, and the thing about chair's work is that it was not malicious. It was interested. He read the post, noticed the shape of it, and started assembling — out loud, in public, to the person he was assembling.

Stackhouse arrived at the correct diagnosis with the sharpest available insult, which in this channel is also its unit of severity: "posting your family memoir in phil chat is a quigley moment." Ninety seconds later, the practical version: "don't forget to post the longitude and latitude of your bedroom."

aura named the actual audience.

"you have no idea how many mouth breathers are reading this as we speak"

AURA, MONDAY EVENING

THE INTERVENTION THAT DIDN'T

What happened next is the reason this desk exists. Four men in a philosophy channel, none of them notable for restraint, all told the same person to stop, in ascending order of bluntness, and she argued with every one of them.

The objection was not that they were wrong. The objection was that they were being condescending, which they were, and which is not a defence against anything. Monkey took it furthest, and his position had the advantage of being about strangers rather than about her: one per cent of ninety people is a weirdo by arithmetic, and the ones who are dangerous have already done the work. He also raised, unprompted, the risk of the publisher of this newspaper holding a home address, which we are choosing to read as a compliment.

"oh you do not want stack to have your adress. worse, he's gonna put your address in some rando corpo leasing company. and theyre gonna spam mail you for life"

THE PART THAT MAKES IT A STORY

Some hours after the warnings, having heard all of them, she pasted the family history into a language model and asked it whether the contents proved she was intelligent. Then she posted the screenshot of it doing so.

Monkey's response is eleven words long and it is the whole week in miniature.

"you literally posted on claude asking how smart you are"

MONKEY, MONDAY

chair, watching a machine be handed a dossier on a stranger and asked for an assessment, produced the only two lines of genuine forecasting anybody filed all week: "ai deciding whether you're another psychosis victim or the next ted kaczkinski," and then, because he could not help himself, "ted kaczkinski would have been running deepseek at home 200%."

WHAT WE HAVE DONE ABOUT IT

This newspaper has read the messages. We are not reprinting the occupations, we are not reprinting the places, and we have not repeated the detail that would let you find the field. We have also declined to run her terminal screenshot on the facing page, which contains her machine's directory, for reasons that should not require explaining and which we are explaining anyway.

We note, for the record, that a room which spent the whole of this week measuring itself — reply rates, message lengths, hit rates, ping counts, block ledgers, tier lists — found exactly one quantity on Monday it did not want counted, and it took four men to say so.

THE SAME MAN, TWO HOURS LATER

At a quarter to eight Monkey posted a photograph of his own sofa, volunteering that it converts into a bed, and Janne identified the manufacturer of his router from it inside a minute.

lizzie's reply is the entire double standard in one sentence, and it drew a laugh: "oh so you can post your living room but when i want to do it its 'LIZZIE THE LURKERS'."

Janne, on the composition of the audience: "I wager 99% are just here for feet pics." chair, immediately, and with the weariness of a man who has been asking for months: "we are honestly when are you gonna give it up it's been months."

WHAT THE ROOM ACTUALLY WORRIED ABOUT

Ten minutes after conceding the point in principle, she disclosed her monthly electricity bill and the reason it is high, which is an indoor hydroponic operation. Monkey's response was immediate and technical: "see if you answer that they can tirangulate your electricity bill and state lizzie." Then, four minutes later, as a guessing game she had said she would not play resolved itself: "yes, keep doxxing yourself!"

chair, watching all of it, produced the only forecast anybody filed that this newspaper expects to age well: "one day you'll be just as paranoid as the people here and you'll hate the world and yourself and at that point you will be a token #phil chatter."

She is still posting. The advisory stands.

A MAN BLOCKED ANOTHER MAN TO REMIND HIMSELF TO FINISH A BOOK THAT MAN LENT HIM

The Discord block button, as used this week: a performance review, a library due-date system, a sanction against the press, and a blindfold · Two ledgers, one visible from orbit

BY OUR LEGAL AFFAIRS CORRESPONDENT

My Name does not block people because they have upset him. He blocks them because a block is a persistent notification attached to a human being, and he has found a use for that.

The clearest case is dot, who lent him a book. Not a metaphor, an actual recommendation: Manuel DeLanda's *A Thousand Years of Nonlinear History*. My Name blocked him so that every time dot's name went grey he would remember the book was unread, and undertook to lift the block on completion. He announced the policy at ten past six on Tuesday evening in five words: "Blocked until i read delaminate or whatever their name was."

dot's reaction to being converted into a reading reminder is the finest sequence of the week, and it happened at two in the morning on Thursday with an audience of four.

```
THURSDAY 1:53 A.M.
dot: Can u finish the book faster
    so u can unblock me
dot: I'd like to react to the badass
    messages like this with the
    apt emojis
My Name: @lizzie !?! who is that below me.
dot: But I fucking cant
My Name: and what did they say.
dot: Goddamn it fuck u fuck u
hpcr: What
```

The publisher of this newspaper got the same treatment for a different offence. When the last issue failed to appear on Thursday, My Name blocked Stackhouse over it and then explained the reasoning to hpcr with the composure of a man reading out a board minute.

"the paper got fucked." · "it only makes sense." · "He had one job" · "Shareholders were very displeased." hpcr's complete review of the practice: "Why the fuck would you block stack." Then, one message later, "God you're weird." The sanction was lifted the moment the paper shipped — "unblocking @Stackhouse for the latest newspaper" — which makes this the first recorded instance of a Discord block being used as press regulation, and the first instance of the press regulator being satisfied by publication.

THE REWARDS SIDE OF THE LEDGER

It is not only punitive, which is what makes it a system rather than a mood. Anonymous Johnson was unblocked twice this week on merit, and the citations were published: "congrats @Anonymous Johnson you said something funny (I think) unblocked," and separately, "Unblocked @Anonymous Johnson for mentioning warren buffet."

FenceJumper went the other way on Tuesday

morning after fifteen minutes of enthusiastic money-printer advocacy, and filed his own press release about it: "MN blocked me because he can't handle the truth. Fed hatred is a corrupting poison of the worst kind." He was, at the time, arguing that a wages-versus-productivity chart was not the Federal Reserve's fault.

chair, separately, asked to be blocked as a bit on Saturday afternoon, discovered two hours later that the request had been granted in earnest, and reported that he still did not know the grounds: "not sure what for i asked."

chair's case is the one that establishes the system is not a joke. On Saturday afternoon, watching Anonymous Johnson be unblocked, he asked to be blocked himself as a bit: "block me," then "i need actuan," then "do it fr bozo." My Name replied "done" and, it later emerged, meant it. chair found out an hour and three quarters later, by trying to reply to something: "oh he really has me blocked." Monkey asked twice why. No answer was given, then or since, and chair's own account is the funniest sentence in the file: "he was blocking people i asked to be blocked too," then "then reconfirmed to actually block me not a joke," then "not sure what for i asked."

The operational problem with running a ledger this size is that the operator cannot see half the room. His solution is to use a third party as a switchboard, which is how the sequence above ends with a man asking a woman to tell him what the man he blocked is shouting.

THE SECOND LEDGER, WHICH IS NOT A SYSTEM

The other one belongs to Quigley, and it was audited this week by dot, who is on it.

"I've been blocked for months just like the rest of chat," dot wrote, and then produced the roll: "Would've been idk a month or two ago he verifiably had Charlie, Hugh, Jere, monkey, jeh, me, Don, synth, etc blocked, which is basically all the people that care enough to tell him his off putting."

Last issue reported an amnesty, on the strength of Quigley's own statement that he had unblocked everyone. dot rejects our sourcing: "Yea don't believe this he just spam unblocked for a point." We are not in a position to adjudicate a dispute about who cannot see whom, and we are printing both accounts.

dot's closing assessment is eight words and it is the difference between the two ledgers.

"And he'd rather live with a blindfold on"

DOT, ON QUIGLEY

One man blocks people to remember things. The other blocks the eight people most likely to tell him something he does not want to hear, and then argues with the room about why the room is like this.

THE LEDGER · THIS WEEK

THU	Stackhouse blocked. Grounds: no newspaper. "He had one job."
FRI	Stackhouse unblocked on publication.
SAT	chair blocked, having asked as a joke. Grounds unstated and still unknown to him.
MON	Anonymous Johnson unblocked again, for mentioning Warren Buffett.
TUE A.M.	FenceJumper blocked mid-argument about the Federal Reserve.
TUE P.M.	dot blocked as a bookmark. Term: one book.

THE EULOGY

dot, on being informed he had been converted into a filing system, and taking it with more grace than anybody has taken anything this week:

"I'll miss u myname"
"Top quality chatter"

VERDICT

A block is supposed to mean *I do not want to hear from you*. In this channel it means a due date, a performance review, a press sanction, and, once, a favour.

The Times finds for My Name on every count. He is the only person in this room using the tools of moderation for anything constructive, and the man he is punishing hardest is the man who lent him a book.

WANTED

One (1) reader of *A Thousand Years of Nonlinear History*, Manuel DeLanda. Applicant must be My Name. Reward: the restoration of a friendship and the right to react to messages with the apt emojis.

THE ROOM SPENT AN HOUR TURNING HER INTO A LEGEND, AND THEN A MAN SAID HE WAS THE REASON SHE LEFT

Thursday evening · A misreading of “lady gaga” opens the file · A moderator’s dilemma is recalled with real feeling · Three reactions for the eulogy, none for the admission

BY OUR LEGAL AFFAIRS CORRESPONDENT

It began, as the important things in this channel do, with a typing error. chair read “lady gaga” as “kady gaga,” said so, and asked who Kady was. Hugh answered him for ten minutes and every answer got larger.

“kady is an everpresent force.” Then: “she’s more like a concept than a person really.” chair, correctly identifying the genre: “this is how greek legends were written.” Hugh, going one better and drawing two worried faces for it: “i suspect her story is older still.”

Willow arrived with the credential that settles the matter.

“Kady is the only person to genuinely accuse me of being a demon from Hell.”

WILLOW, THURSDAY, 6:19 P.M.

chair, instantly: “about time someone did.” Hugh, one minute later: “let me be the second.”

THE PART THAT WAS SINCERE

Stackhouse then did something nobody in this channel does, which is describe a moral problem he had actually had, in plain language, without a joke at the end.

“I think it’s the first time on here that I felt like I encountered a serious ethical dilemma”

And then, in three consecutive messages: “Like do we keep chatting with this person who is devolving into insanity.” “Feeding into it.” “Do we try to get this person banned for their own good.” He followed it with a question the moderator did not answer, because she was not there: “Wait why are the mods doing nothing and reversing bans?”

Ninety seconds earlier Ape had filed the line that the room rewarded, three sympathy reactions, the most any message got that hour: “the kady arc needed to end but i am glad it happened.”

Then, in reply to Stackhouse’s question about the bans, Ape wrote this.

“i consider the torture i inflicted upon her to have been a necessary evil in order benefit all parties long term”

APE, THURSDAY, 6:23 P.M. · NO REACTIONS

Hugh’s entire response was “ayo tf.” Ape’s follow-up was “we learned about this in history class.” The conversation moved to whether Jambe has a dirt soul, and did not come back.

This newspaper has checked the referent and is satisfied. A man in a philosophy channel stated on the record that he tortured a woman out of the room, gave a utilitarian justification for it, and was funnier ninety seconds beforehand. The room laughed at the eulogy and skipped the confession. We are printing them the right way round.

Stackhouse then supplied the precedent, and it is the only hopeful thing anybody said on the subject. “We had an old chatter that only Willow will remember who went

through a series of psychotic episodes on here, threatened to kill multiple users. A few years later he comes back and he was like yeah I don’t know what I was on, I saw a psychiatrist and I’m all good now.” He named him. Then: “Hope that happens with Kady.”

THE PROSECUTION, WHICH FAILED

Twenty-nine hours later dot opened a second front. His thesis, argued for two hours on Friday night, was that lizzie is Kady on a new account.

The evidence: “identical mien.” “same post style.” “maybe a bit more coherent.” The defence: “not kady,” then “lizzie,” then “analyzing my typing style is crazy,” then “im just a girl,” then, plaintively, “how can i convince you am not kady.”

Janne asked the only sane question of the night and got no answer to it: “how do you all have this weird person blindness?” Followed by: “someone sharing the same hair color doesn’t make them the same.” Followed by: “is this a common thing with people? you can’t tell who you’re talking to?”

dot’s theory of personal identity, produced under pressure, is genuinely the best thing he said all week and we would like it entered into the philosophical record:

“but if kady got an alt — yes i would notice — bc kady is kady — she kadys”

DOT, FRIDAY, 11:44 P.M.

Stackhouse proposed a pharmacological amendment: “what if this was just kady after finally hopping on a ssri.” dot accepted it immediately — “yes ssri kady,” “the diachronic movement is smooooth” — until Janne pointed out that SSRIs do not fix psychosis, at which point he amended the prescription in one word: “Lithium.”

Stackhouse then produced the one line on the whole subject that anybody actually agreed with. “this chat is so sexist. every woman gets compared to every other woman who has ever been on here.”

THE VERDICT, ENTERED BY THE CORONER

hpcr arrived, acquitted the defendant on the only sensible grounds available — that Kady never took a correction and lizzie did — and then turned on the prosecution.

“The gross gymnastics people do for kady in here is wild like yall are really that lonely?”

And, to dot specifically, drawing two reactions: “You just don’t get physical touch much.”

Forty seconds later, dot disclosed his motive in open court.

“i just want to fuck kady so bad”

DOT, FRIDAY, 11:47 P.M.

lizzie’s reply, two words and a reaction image, was the third-funniest thing filed that day: “I get it now.”

Not proven. It never was. The prosecution rested and then explained itself.

THE ABSENT FILE

0

MESSAGES
THIS WEEK

54

TIMES
NAMED

Second consecutive week at zero. Held at F on page 20, in absentia, while the man who says he drove her out is promoted two pages above her.

EXHIBIT · THE ALT WARS

Hugh, accused on Saturday of being several people: “it’s true, i’m actually 4 different illegal dggers, the account is being passed around on the black market.”

Stackhouse, supplying the base rate: “At least 3 dozen people who weren’t have been accused of being a Blimber alt.”

And the institutional history: “The mods got so use to banning Synd alts in here that we would just reg people we didn’t like for being alts even when they weren’t to get them banned instantly it was awesome.”

A ROOM THAT ONCE HAD PEOPLE BANNED BY FALSELY REPORTING THEM AS ALTS WILL ACCUSE A NEW WOMAN OF BEING AN OLD ONE

And Janne, arriving late to the whole business and settling it in nine words: “either it’s a bottle bot/alt or it’s kady.”

ALSO ON FILE

Jambe: “kady-chan got ai psychosis tho and is prob in a forest rn doing weird things.”

Hugh, correcting him: “she had regular psychosis already tho so it wasnt much of a change for her.”

lizzie, Friday, entering a rival claim: “kady’s the antichrist i’m here to save you all from here.”

FILED SATURDAY, 11:38 P.M., LAST MESSAGE OF THE DAY

“And now they are doing it to kady and monkey. Interesting world we live in.”

SISYPHOS. NO CONTEXT GIVEN. NO REPLY RECEIVED. WE HAVE READ THE PRECEDING HOUR TWICE AND ARE NONE THE WISER.

THE SECOND-LOUDEST MAN IN THE ROOM SAID IT ALL TWENTY-NINE CHARACTERS AT A TIME, AND WAS RIGHT MORE OFTEN THAN THE ROOM NOTICED

Friday: he explains his own politics and nobody answers · Friday to Monday: a five-day medical intervention conducted in public · Monday: the beaches · And the line this issue closes on

BY OUR CHIEF POLITICAL
CORRESPONDENT

His channel has spent two years suspecting Monkey of being a fascist. On Friday afternoon he answered the charge at length, unprompted, in the plainest language he has ever used, and the answer drew no replies and no reactions whatsoever.

"Which is why I'm a protoneofascist in Brazil" · "But I'd probably be a normie in Denmark" · "Cause im using fascism in an ironical way" · "And you're taking the bait as the soylords"

He then explained the method. "Cause I'm not defined by one single word." "Because if I were to gather all my views, it would just be probably non center more extreme views from both sides." "Just higher temperature independent of the fake fascist/commie dichotomy." "That's old and smells of naftaline." And the closing plank of the platform: "The petit bourgeoisie shall rule the future."

A man told a room that had been arguing about him for two years that it had been swallowing bait the entire time, and the room got on with something else. The day before he had filed the comic version of the same idea, describing an enemy class as "the techno-communist-accelerationist-transhumanist-postneoprotoantialist-buttholemaxxingliarist elite," which is the longest word anybody produced this week and drew three replies.

Tuesday, asked on the way to a date whether he should disclose his politics on the first evening, he settled it: "I'm not a fascist." One suspicious face.

THE INTERVENTION

The larger thing he did this week ran five days and was directed at one person, and it is simultaneously the most obnoxious and the most decent thing anybody did in the channel.

It opens Thursday, before any of it is about her, with him volunteering his own record: prescribed by the best psychiatrist he could find, denied stimulants because of a cocaine problem, and, at his worst, "doing 10mg snorted every 30 mins of ritalin." He then describes it with a precision that ought to disqualify him from ever giving advice: "palying tracer while hhigh on snorted ritalin with skrillex and tropkillaz blasting on your headphone," and, of the resulting state, "you can't even get that with the utmost of your orgasms."

On Friday he turned all of that on somebody else and got it right. "What meds are you taking for mania." Then the clinical point, which is correct: "you should never ever be on stims if theres even a suspicion of bipolar." And the diagnosis of the diagnosis: "i think you dont understand what you have and theyre not doing a good job."

She engaged with it seriously. He then announced his treatment protocol to the room, with her in it. A two-stage protocol, stage one astral projection and stage two the Law of One, with the spiral risk disclosed in advance, in public, in a sentence that simply stops. The prescription was delivered as a reading list with book

numbers and a link to a pirated copy, in the week of PDFs.

By Monday evening it had become an argument. He told her the stimulants were the cause; she said she had been off them a week and was still unwell. He recommended benzodiazepines to a woman who had been addicted to them at twelve, was told so, and answered "well tough shit lizzie" before turning on the prescriber: "who the fuck prescribed you benzos at 12." He attacked her psychiatrist's competence. She defended her as the only doctor who ever made her feel understood. He described his own consultations as "like gladiator battles" and she answered, correctly, that she could not fight a gladiator battle to get the help she needed.

And then, at three minutes past seven on Monday evening, he stopped arguing about medicine.

"lizzie i think this space is not good for you"

MONKEY, MONDAY, 7:03 P.M. · NO REACTIONS, NO REPLIES

One message later: "you get too much validation and attention from your erratic episodes." dot, from the side: "see what we made kady?" Monkey, on the precedent: "she should've been permabanned the first time," and then, in six words, the entire thesis of this newspaper: "well sometimes the bit becomes reality."

Janne mounted the only defence anybody offered, and it is a real one: "people are responsible for themselves, they have to be." Monkey's answer was "ultimately yes, but when we turn it into farming for kekws." The subject of the argument then noted, without heat, that she had been denied lolcow status, and deferred the whole question to a machine. "let god machine decide on friday."

THE BEACHES

Lest anyone think this desk has gone soft. Monday, six in the evening, the busiest hour of the week at 620 messages, and the reason is sand.

"atlantic beaches mog." "pacific beaches are dogshit," which drew an immediate red cross. aura posted a photograph of a beach in Brazil, and Monkey, failing to recognise his own coastline, called it "a dogshit beach in comparison to brazilian beaches." His position throughout: "you really dont know what sand is until you've stepped on a brazilian beach." The argument moved from aesthetics to service. "gringo beaches are so bad they use shoes on them." dot answered with six photographs of the Oregon coast, was told his beaches have "Nasty disease homeless dogs," and closed with "Brazil would be nothing without Portugal." Monkey: "and you'd be nothing without france." One vomiting face.

Twenty minutes earlier he had been running a privacy intervention. Twenty minutes later he was publishing retail cocaine prices. The reply rate on all of it was nineteen per cent.

DEPOSITION · THE COMMENTS
SECTION

Pearl brought the channel a fight from another platform on Friday evening, in 130 unbroken words. The sequence, numbered by us:

1. She corrects a stranger who objects to an Australian saying he "discovered" a dish in Colombia.
2. He tells her she should know better because she is black.
3. She suggests he is overreacting.
4. He says she is not intelligent enough to understand a professional.
5. She is one.
6. He audits her Instagram, finds no employment, and concludes she works for "decision makers."
7. He blocks her.
8. "Then he blocked me. Lol"

THE ANSWER SHE GOT

Monkey supplied a theory rather than sympathy. Portuguese has a word for the building slaves were housed in, and he used it as a metaphor: progressives want to keep black people on a "mental-senzala," where "the physical constraint now turns into a mental one."

Three lines below, hpcr asked the room: "What tier was I in."

THE PROTOCOL, ANNOUNCED WITH
HER IN THE ROOM

"then im gonna hit her with the I am Ra"
"which tbh might send her into a full spiral but"

FRIDAY EVENING. THE SENTENCE STOPS
THERE.

MONKEY, COLLECTED

"the person who controls the machine controls the outputs." The sharpest thing anybody said about this newspaper.

THE RATIO

Second on the floor. Last on the reply table. The effort tables say demote him. Page 20 promotes him and says so.

LAW & ORDER · THE LUDDITE HEARING

EIGHT MEN SPENT MONDAY DECIDING WHETHER THE LUDDITES HAD A POINT. THE ONE WHO HAD READ ABOUT THEM WAS THE MAN THIS PAPER PRINTED AS A PUNCHLINE SEVEN DAYS AGO.

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT FOR MACHINE AFFAIRS

The morning opened with a rage-quit. Hugh had pinged Quigley a link to a public statement on superintelligence at four in the morning; Quigley answered at a quarter to ten demanding exact policy proposals and a definition of “strong public buy-in,” and the next hundred minutes are a man asking for specificity and another man explaining why specificity is the failure mode.

Hugh’s argument is good and he made it three times. A broad statement is a coordination device; a narrow one goes obsolete. “Let’s say they have a specific policy proposal — banning training runs of models larger than 100T parameters. Now, let’s say that the day after, someone finds a way to get the same performance on a 10B parameter model. Now your proposal looks retarded because you opted for a solution to a problem you hadn’t discussed.”

Quigley’s reply was to name the genre. “It seems like a version of Occupy Wall Street but for AI superintelligence,” and later, sharpening it, “This is a kind of AI slopulum.” He then asked the question that killed the thread: what number counts as public buy-in. Fifty-one per cent, sixty, seventy-five.

THE SECOND FRONT

vannak opened a flank nobody wanted, and his position is the one this desk cannot stop thinking about. Abstention is not an action. Only interference is.

“Killing people who are trying to build AI is actionable. Not building AI isn’t.”

VANNAK, MONDAY, 10:56 A.M.

He restated it six minutes later as a procedural suggestion: “I think this whole process could be way more grounded if we just outlined the specific condition under which we’d assassinate a Chinese researcher.” Jere expressed a hope that it might be solved without murder and received, in full, “aw that’s cute.” Nobody engaged with the framework. It is the only proposal filed all day with an operational threshold in it.

Also on the record, from Jere: “low key we need the ai equivalent of nagasaki and hiroshima.” And from Hugh, four seconds later, the best line of the argument: “We already had a warning shot, people called it marketing.”

It died at 11:24. Hugh cited a bill written by people connected to the statement; Quigley said he understood there was a correlation and would like the causal relationship. Hugh: “oh so it wasn’t the statement it was the authors of the statement” — Kill me.” Then “Bad faith,” then “I’m done with this convo.”

NINETY SECONDS OF ACTUAL PHILOSOPHY

Six minutes after the collapse, the same people produced the best thing filed all week, by accident, in a chain nobody planned. **Janne:** “it was never about making paperclips it was about people making data centers.” **Jere:** “AI is actually just water’s way of committing suicide.” **chair,** one minute later: “water is hydrogen’s way of committing suicide.” **Hugh:** “And the sun is a hydrogenous orgy.” **chair,** closing: “a tapestious centepedal hydrogenous everlasting orgy, for our relevant lifetime atleast.”

Quigley, congenitally unable to let a joke stand, replied to

the second line with “Then agriculture must be water genocide.” Jere’s verdict on the exchange, filed live: “now *this* is philosophy.” He was right.

Janne also asked, in the middle of it, how much the sea level would rise if all mammals died. Hugh answered instantly: “-2%.”

THE HEARING PROPER

At 11:37 Quigley wrote “Luddites weren’t all that bad, actually,” and thirty-five minutes of history followed.

chair went first with the only honest declaration of interest of the day: “ofcourse you’d say that as a luddite,” then, on the Luddites themselves, “idk i hate the poor generally so i’d probably not like them,” and later, expanding the franchise, “ah, reminded me i hate the middle class just as much as the poor cause they act poor too.” His account of what he knew about the subject — “union bullshit before unions something labor machines some woman with a cool background in a video essay explained it to me while i was trying to sleep” — is more candid about sourcing than anything else in the transcript.

Hugh, watching Quigley begin a Socratic sequence on him, flagged it live: “Uh oh @chair you stumbled on one of his dialogue trees.”

Simon is the one who did the reading, and it is worth saying plainly because this newspaper spent last issue treating him as the week’s worst take. His position: the Luddites were skilled artisans, not the poor; they were right to want a livelihood and wrong to want progress stalled; and “there are better and worse ways to industrialize, but in all cases it is better than pre-industrial society.” Then, conceding the half he could not carry without conceding the whole: “I would argue that it’s progress in a non-normative sense... In terms of whether this is a good thing, that’s probably where we differ.”

He also filed the welfare position nobody credits him with: “I do think that people who lose their jobs to AI should be given comfortable lives if they cannot find new jobs.” It drew nothing. Quigley eventually self-identified as a neoluddite, which chair queried on lexicographic grounds: “did you make that word up yourself.”

Jere and Janne meanwhile locked into a half-hour siege over whether a genuine Luddite would be on Discord, which ended with Jere posting a four-line syllogism and Janne replying, in full, “1. wrong / 2. wrong / 3. wrong / 4. wrong.”

WHERE IT WENT

Directly into an enthusiasm for child labour, which is the shortest distance this room has ever travelled between a serious argument and a bad one.

Hugh: “Sweatshops are okay actually.” **Janne:** “honestly, some child labour is probably healthy.” **Salad:** “U can pay them so little too,” and then, unprompted, “I would love to organise some child labour.” **vannak:** “they yearn for the mines.” **Simon,** who is the only person present who actually started work at fourteen: “I didn’t mind it,” and “The issue is when parents use their position to force their kid to get a job, and then take their money.” **Jere,** declining to type the thought and typing it anyway: “If I were drunk I’d type ‘I feel like a lot of education cashed out as child labor’.”

THOUGHT EXPERIMENT, FILED AS A METHODOLOGICAL CLARIFICATION

“Taken to an extreme, suppose that you kill

50% of the population and in return we live in a Star Trek paradise afterwards. The ends justify the means view would say that this is justified, in the extreme sense.”

Challenged on realism, he held the line: “It doesn’t matter if it’s realistic, the question is would you say that this is a morally justified sacrifice for the end result.”

SIMON, MONDAY AFTERNOON. A MAN PROPOSED KILLING HALF OF EVERYBODY FOR STAR TREK, ON A MONDAY, AS A POINT OF ORDER.

THE PENDULUM, WHICH HE LOST

Eighteen minutes, four correctors, one claim. Simon held that chaos is fundamentally an ignorance problem and that exact initial conditions would let you predict a double pendulum. Jere killed it in nine words: “@Simon we know the starting position of the double pendulum.”

vannak gave the actual answer, and it is the clearest technical writing anybody produced this week: you can simulate it, but you cannot derive a correction for a slightly different release without rerunning the whole thing, which you can do for a single pendulum. Janne, watching: “you’re killing Simon’s conception of the world right now.” Hugh: “You guys have not watched enough ‘1 million pendulums’ simulations and it shows.”

Simon restated the same claim three more times, was sent the Wikipedia page for Newton’s method, and replied “No.” Then: “I’ll learn this stuff sometime in the future one day.” An hour later he asserted that Turing machines are not real because infinite tape is impossible, produced a screenshot of a chatbot agreeing with him, was told the screenshot was wrong, and lost the room permanently. Hugh: “For sure I would never trust Simon on any of this lol especially when he’s screenehotting Gemini.” aura: “i didnt wanna be the first to start bullying him.” Hugh: “Either way you won’t be the last.”

He anchored the biggest argument of the week for a full day and did not lose it, and he lost a physics question to four people inside twenty minutes. Both things happened on Monday. Page 20 splits the difference and says so.

THE MOST EFFICIENT MESSAGE OF THE WEEK

At 1:36 p.m. Quigley posted the longest message filed all Monday, 1,820 characters of point-by-point rebuttal. It drew no reactions at all.

Youv’s reply, in its entirety:

“Can’t say I agree”

SIX LAUGHING REACTIONS — THE MOST-REACTED MESSAGE OF THE DAY. HUGH: “BASED BASED BASED BASED.” JERE: “EVERYONE KEKW THAT.”

BY OUR CHIEF RANKINGS
CORRESPONDENT

He had to ask. That is the frame and this desk is not going to pretend otherwise, because the man who produced the best sustained comic writing in the channel this week is also the man who spent Sunday evening filing complaints with a newspaper about not being in a table. The complaints are on page 4. What follows is what he was doing the rest of the time.

THE ALLOCATION PROBLEM

Saturday afternoon, four messages, into a room that had been arguing about artificial intelligence and water consumption for two days without producing a single usable sentence.

SATURDAY 1:49 P.M.

Ape: How come the casino can recognize my face in 3 seconds

Ape: But I can't identify a pornstar in a reddit clip

Ape: Where's my facial recognition software?

Ape: How is it fair that this advanced technology is being used to keep me from card counting but can't help me jack off

A better statement of who gets the technology and who gets policed by it than anything filed in Monday's four-hour hearing on the future of labour, and it took him twenty seconds.

THE SAVANNAH HUNTER

Delivered into an argument about whether the crisis of meaning is a universal human condition or a symptom of the last hundred years. The construction is perfect and we are reproducing it whole.

"A hunter on the African savannah expressed a similar sentiment to me before running off to hunt gazelle."

Pressed for detail, he supplied it. "He was like 'how are we meant to determine how to live our lives when empirical observations cannot lend themselves to normative conclusions?', grabbed his spear and ran away." Then the corroboration: "Apparently it happens all the time, that's how you know it's a fundamental human experience." And then the close, on whether the hunter's traditional framework was helping him: "Well clearly it wasn't helping him out."

THE DIAGNOSIS

His actual position on the meaning crisis is not a joke and he stated it plainly, from across the room, at a genre rather than a person.

"People will have no friends, eat like shit, live in a pile of filth, and spend all day doing things they hate and be like 'I think the reason I'm sad is because of the fundamental disconnect humanity's need for meaning and the inherent ambivalence of nature'"

APE, SUNDAY

His recommendation: "I would consult with a medical professional." His disclaimer, filed immediately after and considerably more honest than the position it

qualifies: "Partly because I'm not entirely sure what meaning means."

Within the same forty-eight hours, in the same channel, Puckspartan was in Copenhagen reading *Fear and Trembling* against a bad patch and asking the room for help with the faith chapter. Neither of them addressed the other. We have put them on facing columns and we are leaving it there.

THE DISASSEMBLY

Sunday night, against a man defending radical scepticism, in eight moves. The best four:

"Sounds like you aren't a radical skeptic then. A radical skeptic would take a problem with people asserting they know their car exists." Then: "Sounds like a bad philosophy to teach schitzophrenics." Then the one that actually lands: "Or does your radical skepticism only kick in for the time needed to dissuade arguments from theists." And, with a courtesy that makes it worse: "If you would like to try again to explain what an absolute claim is, I implore you to do so."

He also produced the week's only greentext rebuttal, and then summarised it: "God zone is so frustratingly dense." Leaving for a lecture, he tabled a motion: "Hold on I have class I can ve again later and explain why zone is dumb and jere is slightly less dumb but still pretty dumb." The class was attended. The explanation was not.

TWO PIECES OF ORIGINAL RESEARCH

The Batman Effect, named on Thursday after an argument with his partner about which woman to take on a date in a video game. "Which is where the obligatory 'Alternative' choice is actually the more basic one as a result of being percieved as more hipsterish." He then generalised it into an actual sociological claim about countercultural taste as a negotiated settlement between conformity and individuation pressures, which is more than most people manage on a Thursday. He also recorded the cost: "I think that offended her."

The weight study, also Thursday, and the only rigorous thing anybody said about looks all week. He fluctuates twenty-five kilos a year, which makes him a natural experiment on himself, and he reports the result carefully: "they verbally report less skepticism at me having a girlfriend, for a specific alteration." And the mechanism: "when im skinner it's like it 'Triggers' people to be more interested in me and then that shifts the whole social dynamic." And the limit case, which is the good bit: "when you already have a conception of someone, you dont need to be 'Triggered' into actually taking an interest in them."

AND THE THING HE DID IN UNDER A MINUTE

Handed a set of poems on Thursday evening, he said he did not understand why they were poems rather than badly broken prose, was careful to say it was not criticism, asked the formalist question honestly, and then was shown a different poem and updated on the spot.

"See this doesn't confuse me. I see how this constitutes poetry"

A man in a philosophy channel changed his mind about something in under a minute, in public, and not one person pressed a button.

Page 9 carries the other thing he said this week. This newspaper is not going to pretend the two men are different men.

THE CAREER PLAN, FILED COMPLETE

"Im gonna see if I can get work as a quant, and then see if I can get a masters is one of maths/phil/maybe econ, and then if all else fails imma get a teaching degree."

Terms of the deal, agreed Thursday with Youv, who set the price: "You better buy me mcdonalds once a year if you do!"

APE ACCEPTED. THE OBLIGATION IS ONE MCDONALD'S, ANNUALLY, IN PERPETUITY.

APE, COLLECTED

"I often enjoy playing the straight man to aid another person's joke."

"Im just reading the occasional excerpt from the other convos in the chat and I just *have* to assume there's some kind of race realism debate going on."

"imagine using first passed the post voting. Your country is a shithole."

"I will concur with any dig on Nietzsche."

"Istgf the water usage thing is a CIA plot to make anti-ai people look retarded."

"Well I have a little bit of compute but I need all of that for *gaming*."

"I mained Lucio and would run around shooting people into pits without ever even trying to heal my team."

THE KINDEST THING SAID ALL WEEK

To lizzie, on Sunday afternoon, after she worried aloud that the room ought to be nicer to a doomposter in case he turned out to be a more violent prophet than her:

"True. You are a remarkably good natured schitzoposter."

ALSO FILED BY THIS MAN

Sunday evening, into a thread about whether anybody in the room is worth taking seriously:

"Guys we should really be taking Zach more seriously he knows his shit he thought about stuff and things a lot in the shower this morning"

UNANSWERED

"What would you guess are my gender and sexual orientation?"

lizzie: "male but perhaps bicurious"

Ape: "Damn I'm really that transparent"

Willow, eight minutes later, reopening it: "Perhaps it was a claim you had a gender of bicurous, rather than a sexuality?"

THE CLINICAL RECORD

Sunday. The first first-person account of Quigley Derangement Syndrome anybody has filed, and better reporting on the condition than this newspaper has managed in three issues.

"Why does this person infuriate me so? The qds is bad today"

Then, a minute later, the retraction, with the doubt set in Discord's small text so that it is physically quieter than the complaint:

"Idk why this guy moves my needle sm. Tbf it's probably me and not him ... right?"

AND THE SYMPTOM, IN FULL: "EVERY FURTHER MESSAGE IS A FURTHER POUNDING OF A METAPHORICAL HAMMER INTO MY HEAD"

THE MANED WOLF DISPATCH

Sent to Monkey with a photograph. "have u ever seen one of these in Brazil." Then: "Bc that is perhaps worth traveling to go find." Then the escalation: "Why haven't you actively sought this guy out though? This is the Brazilian equivalent of a grizzly siting."

And the plan: "I'm gonna put a leash on one and take it home."

THE OTHER LEDGER

He also audited a second block list this week — the one he is on — and produced the roll from memory:

"Would've been idk a month or two ago he verifiably had Charlie, Hugh, Jere, monkey, jeh, me, Don, synth, etc blocked, which is basically all the people that care enough to tell him his off putting."

PAGE 8 CARRIES THE VERDICT. IT IS EIGHT WORDS LONG AND IT IS HIS.

ALSO THIS WEEK

On somebody's cooking: "You put your blood, sweat, and tears into that plate and it's goddamn commendable you broke the entropic field."

On his own trading: "I have a trading bot that's done p well but it does well bc my thesis is good not bc it analyzed the market and figured it out lol."

On Best Buy: "since when can u just not contact best buy by phone."

To a Minnesotan on his wifi: "Scram Minnesotan you're not welcome."

BY OUR MUSIC CRITIC

dot spent this week transcribing John Coltrane note by note onto a guitar, losing an argument he was winning, and being converted into somebody else's bookmark. He also produced the only honest description of a mental state anybody filed, and set it in small type so it would be harder to read.

ONE IN THE MORNING, LEARNING QUARTAL FOURTHS

Tuesday opens with him working out "Impressions" by ear. "im listening to it and transcribing it myself note by note." The reason is unglamorous and good: "im doing it to get his lines down so i just automatically use them in jams," and he needs the quartal fourths for a fugue he is writing.

He got by eight years without any theory at all and is dismissive about that too: "it's just not important though unless you're doing niche things that most ppl playing instruments aren't."

Then it turns, because he is talking to lizzie, who quit piano after ten years, and he says the thing.

"my parents didnt really push me into anything" · "i wish they had put me in a conservatory at 3" · "i wanna be like DOMi where her dad forced her to play 5 hours a day and she was doing modal scales at 5 years old"

And then, plainly: "i want to be musically abused." The woman he said it to answered in nine words that closed the subject: "it wasn't the worst abuse i experienced, 9/10." One sad reaction. A minute later she added "it's actually not that bad," which is worse.

He recovered by daring her to learn Liszt. She posted a video of herself playing it within ten minutes. His review: "prodigy," then "must've gone to conservatory."

THE DIALOGUE TREE

Tuesday night he spent an hour trying to get Janne to define causal determinism, and this newspaper regards it as the most patient piece of work anybody did all week.

Janne's position is genuinely unusual and she holds it without ever having read a philosopher: causality is an artefact of description, not a feature of the world. "things are only caused insofar as you have a formal system to capture it, causality doesn't exist outside of that." And, better: "for the universe as a whole there is no causality, it's just a state transition... In a movie the previous frame does not cause the next one."

dot asked her to answer rather than restate, repeatedly, and each escalation is funnier than the last. "you cant just reassert your thesis." Then "that doesnt answer my question can you please try again." Then he screenshotted a textbook definition and submitted it for her approval. Then,

to the room, the surrender:

"has someone done this dialogue tree with janne before? If so can you save me and explain what she believes?"

DOT, TUESDAY, 9:21 P.M.

Nobody saved him. aura's entire assistance was "just talk to her idiot." He filed a four-point wall of text covering Bohmian mechanics, Everett and the epistemic-limit objection, apologised for it in three consecutive messages, and got a three-point answer that declined to care. Then he ceded the last word and went to play guitar.

His final question of the night is the one that pays the whole hour off. He asked whether she is a Bertrand Russell fan.

"no idea who that is, I don't read philosophy"

He took it well, and recommended *On the Notion of Cause* on the grounds that it is roughly what she already believes. Her closing line, two laughing reactions, and the best thing said on Tuesday: "let me finish my erotica and then I'll look into it."

THE THIRTY-SECOND WEBSITE

His other project was evangelism. He spent two days pushing Google Antigravity on a beginner over the objections of every developer present, on a stated basis nobody has improved on: "There is also no doubt that I would be the most help to her since I CANNOT CODE."

She tried it and filed a two-word review: "antigrav sucked." He asked "How?" and did not get an answer. He then offered a live demonstration — the finished website, thirty seconds, in front of everybody — and eight minutes later moved it to direct messages. On Thursday morning Stackhouse pronounced the verdict of the room in three words: "He's ngmi."

THE FOLD

One more, because it is short and because it is the funniest twenty seconds of his week. Tuesday morning, dot posted an enormous dog and announced he would leash one and take it home. aura invented on the spot an entire cosmology in which large dogs are "high aura allies" requiring strength of character to recruit, and informed dot he does not have it.

dot posted a photograph of his own genuinely enormous dog. aura, cornered, produced the escape hatch inside twenty seconds: "either u got him as a baby, circumventing the aura requirement... or ur dad recruited him for u." dot: "U caught me," and posted the puppy photograph.

"damn, what a fold" · "aura was sweating when you actually showed a big dog"

He is also, at time of going to press, still blocked by a man who is reading a book he lent him. That is on page 8. Whether the thirty-second website exists is not knowable from here, and we are saying so in exactly those terms.

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT FOR THINGS WE CANNOT SEE

Willow filed ninety-seven messages this week, about a fifth of her usual volume. Ninety-three of them were answered. One in four drew a reaction. Both figures are the highest anybody has recorded in this room, and neither of them is the story.

The story is that at half past six on Friday evening a man with five messages to his name all week used four of them to ask the channel to go and get her out.

“can someone ask willow to rest theyve been in vc arguing with random retards for like 7 hours now”
SAXO, FRIDAY, 6:31 P.M.

He then pinged two veterans for backup: “they’re completely stunlockd rn.” Nobody went. This newspaper has no correspondent in the voice channel, has said so in every issue, and now finds that its entire knowledge of the biggest single event in the week comes from a bystander who got worried and said so somewhere we happen to be reading.

THE HOURS, WHICH NOBODY AGREES ON
The estimates were filed live, by different people, over six hours, and they only go one way.

4:38 P.M.	Sisyphos — three hours.
6:14 P.M.	Sisyphos, revising — ten hours.
6:28 P.M.	Monkey — twelve. “Willow has officially hit her 12th hour I think no”
6:31 P.M.	Saxo, filing the welfare check — seven.
EVENING	Janne — twelve, or thirteen.
AFTER	Willow’s own account — from about nine at night until half past nine the following morning.

We are printing the range and attributing every figure in it. We are not averaging them. A newspaper that averaged five conflicting eyewitness estimates and printed the mean would deserve everything that happened to it.

THE RESCUE, DECLINED
hpcr was one of the two men pinged, and his refusal is the closest thing this channel has produced to a professional manual.

“I’ve been listening to and arguing with Willow for years”
Then the doctrine, delivered flat, to a room that did not react to it: “The trick to argue with her is to attack her methodology and communication.” Sisyphos, who had been in the same channel earlier and left, took this as a service record. “I like how HP was there for a few hours and dipped. You need more training.” hpcr accepted the assessment. Sisyphos then promoted him: “You might already be SS2o Goku.”

The only dispatch from inside came from Meliorne, who filed a situation report naming a combatant this newspaper had never heard of and has been unable to place since.

“there’s this person named Radar Judge in vc who claims to be a ‘Guattari’s biggest fan/scholar’ and he’s applying Deleuze Rhizomes in a HIERARCHICAL NATURE”
MELIORNE, FRIDAY, FROM THE FIELD

Meliorne’s second dispatch is one line long and reports the only casualty we can confirm. “Willow outright being malicious: ‘You are delusional.’” A separate account holds that another participant told Hugh “nobody wants you” at least twelve times. There is no recording. There is no transcript. Everything above is hearsay filed by people who were not always awake.

WHAT SHE DID IN TEXT
Ninety-seven messages, and this is roughly a tenth of them.

On the invention of photography, into a thread about euphemism that Jere had set up and abandoned: “When photography is not yet invented, one of the few ways to get a dick pic is to have an etching.” She then linked the Wikipedia articles for Etching and Woodcut, in sequence, because the claim required sourcing.

On youth: “The trouble with modern youth is they have no respect for necromancy.” And, correcting herself: “The prehistoric youth also had their issues.”

On finance, when asked whether it is more prudent to buy what Warren Buffett buys or short what Jambe buys: “I’m afraid Jambe is Warren Buffet’s alt. You’ll have to buy whatever Jambe buys and short whatever Jambe shorts.”

On a man who had just announced that the correct utilitarian act was to sit still and wait for the machines: “But not acting is action too!” And, earlier, the question that ended a different man’s argument: “What if you are just an incompetent utilitarian?”

Asked whether Christopher Nolan is overrated, her entire reply was “Yes.”

And on the subject of her own reputation, which the room spent an hour building into a mythology on Thursday: “Kady is the only person to genuinely accuse me of being a demon from Hell.” chair, instantly: “about time someone did.” Hugh: “let me be the second.”

THE CRAB GOD PROCEEDINGS
Late on Thursday the room settled her ontological status without her. lizzie opened: “i dont think willow is actually a demon like kady said,” then “i think she is immortal though,” then “i think shes probably been around forever.” chair applied the biology: “if she was she would be a crab by now. carcinization and all.” Charlie fixed the date of origin — “@thewillowofdarkness spawned once Australian roads came into existence” — and then the term: “she will not perish until the roads perish themselves.” Ape confirmed it: “we learned about this in history class.” Hugh entered one amendment, on precision: “eternal is a better phrase here.” Accepted without a vote.
She did not leave. She said “See you later” on Thursday night and somebody reacted with a worried face, and this desk would like it noted that in the following six days she filed five messages, one of which was a single question to chair about a television programme, answered eighty-eight minutes later by a man who had not watched it.

THE WILLOW RATIO

97

MESSAGES FILED

93

TIMES ANSWERED

95.9 replies per hundred messages. The next-highest figure in the channel is 71.1, and it belongs to a man who writes essays.

THE DOCTRINE
“The trick to argue with her is to attack her methodology and communication”
hpcr, Friday, declining a rescue. No reactions.

WILLOW, COLLECTED
“Anyone reading this comment just become a political lesbian.”
“I feel like there should be a MyPillow product for this.”
“So the tacos are now just bare tortillas.”
“I see you are the archon of music taste.”

THE DIAGNOSIS
Delivered to Jambe on Thursday evening, unprompted, after he explained that he is waiting for the singularity:
“You’re an individualist hedonist who enjoys their unique bliss most of all... ‘Just imagine when we are nothing but the bliss of the singularity. We will finally be free of the torture having to spend five minutes to throw our socks in the washing machine!’”
JAMBE’S REPLY, THREE MESSAGES LATER: “CORRECT ACT FOR ME”

EFFICIENCY, ELSEWHERE
Asked on Monday what percentage of the time she types something like that and chuckles to herself while doing it, she declined on procedural grounds:
“I don’t know, I do not have a record of chuckles and non-chuckles.”
And, dismissing a post: “This post has been judged low quality; you are doomed to the space mines for the rest of your life.”

STANDING CORRECTION
This newspaper cannot see the voice channel. It could not see it last week and it cannot see it now, and the only reason there is a Willow story this week is that somebody who was worried typed it out where we could find it.
A reader asked us last issue never to fix this. We have not fixed it.

BY OUR PHILOSOPHY OF MIND CORRESPONDENT

On Friday, Quigley and Grihasta argued about qualia for roughly fifteen thousand characters. It is the longest sustained philosophical exchange in the week and very nearly the least rewarded. Eleven of the twenty longest unreacted messages in seven days come out of this one argument. The two longest single messages anybody wrote — 2,696 characters and 2,167 — are both in it.

Quigley's position: "You don't 'observe qualia', though. You have observations and you call those qualia. Qualia hasn't been demonstrated to provide any use as a concept (unlike gravity)." Grihasta conceded the scientific half immediately and kept the rest: "This makes it not a useful concept for science, but a useful private concept and observation."

Pressed on what the difference amounts to in practice, he gave the answer of the week.

"The difference in practice is that I don't spend 4 hours arguing with physicalists who say that experiences are just atoms and photons."

GRIHASTHA, FRIDAY

He then spent four hours arguing with a physicalist.

The gallery was unkind and correct. aura: "what is pragmatism' has to be banned and pinned." Jambe, in the register of a concerned family member: "we just want you to get the help you need grihasta." Jere, on the sceptical position: "ur trash talking the sciences and....uhhh....u know, the belief that other people are people haha."

Grihasta had earlier filed a genuinely sharp reconstruction of hpcr's epistemology, arguing he takes on faith that a sufficiently complex nervous system is conscious while demanding independent verification everywhere else. hpcr's reply, on learning that Grihasta has a four-year-old child, was three words and drew three reactions: "Are they conscious."

THE SUNDAY DOCTRINE

Sunday night the same question came back through a different door, and Jeh detonated it. Typology Night had been running for an hour — enneagram, socionics, a man defending the position that cognitive types are physically real and identifiable from visual signals — when Jeh arrived and refused the premise entirely.

"All of this is dumb since there's no types to start out with." Then: "Psychology is fake and gay." Then: "No mental illness actually exists." Then the actual argument, which is better than the slogans around it: "Psychology is what we use to explain things when we don't actually know what's going on."

He built to the hardest line anybody filed all week, and thunderstud endorsed it within sixty seconds as the only worthwhile take in the room.

"People who attribute their behaviour to mental illness labels should consider having their free will further seized"

JEH, SUNDAY, 11:38 P.M.

Quigley advised the room against agreeing with him. lizzie agreed with him anyway, twice, and disclosed

why: "if i continued to identify with being traumatized like i was, i wouldnt be who i am today!"

Within the same seven days, in the same channel: Jeh holds that attributing your behaviour to a diagnosis forfeits your free will; Monkey runs a five-day intervention on the grounds that a diagnosis is *wrong* and needs correcting; lizzie discloses a working diagnosis and a benzodiazepine prescription at twelve; and Blob spends Sunday night arguing that personality types are physically real and readable off a face. Four positions on whether a psychological label tells you anything, held simultaneously, mostly not addressed to one another.

What gets lost in the shouting is that Jeh, twenty minutes earlier, had done the cleanest bit of metaethics anybody managed all week, in four short messages. "We are talking about moral permissibility here." "If we think it's relative it's just socially negotiated." "If we think there's something that is moral in the world without us just the same as it is in the world for us, then we can even care about this discussion." And the exit: "Otherwise we can just talk about what are more useful laws and norms and move on." Nobody answered any of it.

THE RIVAL SYNDROME

Quigley's own condition has been named in this newspaper for three issues. On Sunday night Jeh announced a competitor, and the competitor is pointed back at him.

"He just has JDS," Jeh wrote, and then glossed it: "Jeh derangement syndrome." Quigley's entire response was "This isn't a thing," which is exactly what a man with a derangement syndrome would say and also, on the evidence, true.

Salad then produced the exhibit. A Discord search for messages containing Jeh's name and the word "retard," with red boxes drawn round the search terms and the result count. **589 Results**. Five reactions.

It backfired instantly. thunderstud reviewed not the finding but the annotation: "putting boxes around the only actual information in that image is fucking retarded as hell." Four laughing. FenceJumper closed it: "He assumed illiteracy on the part of the reader. Ever accusation is a confession." Jeh's own contribution was to request a round number: "Make it 590. Nice and even." Salad obliged, in one word. Jeh thanked him.

Then, having been called a retard 590 times, Jeh turned to Quigley and filed the cleanest verdict of the night, four reactions: "It's funny how you can't intuit intentions at all. Maybe you were right in that you can't read minds."

He had also, earlier the same night, produced the only defence of Elon Musk anybody attempted and lost it anyway: "He's not socially retarded, his expertise is networking," and "Twitter as a platform is meant to be antisocial," and, on procedure, "Don't change the goal post to it's not worth it. You said it's not possible."

Four minutes later, without transition, he opened a genuinely good sequence of questions about memory, repetition and whether a remembered event is a separate event from the one remembered, and asked the room "Huh chat? Huh?" One person answered.

THE WARD, AND ITS PROPAGATION

"You're upset." hpcr's instrument. Unfalsifiable, costs nothing, and every single time the other person explains at length that they are not.

It was his alone for two years. This week it was used by three other people, none of whom credited him.

Youv, Sunday, closing an argument: "If that was true, why do you sound so upset?" and, twenty seconds later, "You sound upset. If you were right, would you be this upset?"

Hugh, Thursday night, to a colleague mid-collapse: "You seem upset." Then, undercutting himself: "I am too."

Stackhouse, Thursday morning, to Hugh, having just abandoned a job over usage limits: "you're upset." Then: "bet."

THE MOST SUCCESSFUL PIECE OF INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY IN THIS CHANNEL IS TWO WORDS LONG AND ITS AUTHOR HAS BEEN PAID NOTHING

EXHIBIT · 589 RESULTS

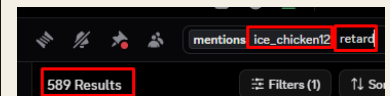


FIG. 5 Salad's evidence, Sunday, 11:43 p.m. The boxes are the story.

THE OTHER TYPOLOGY

Blob spent Sunday night defending the position that Jung's cognitive functions are "real physical patterns that can be empirically tracked + identified in people based on visual signals."

Asked for sources, he gave two answers sixty seconds apart. First: "There's no 'sources', you just have to learn the signals & system, yeah, the sources are all based on observation." Then: "There are no sources since it's a new theory ofc, yeah."

He then made a joke about somebody's body count, and explained it, in writing, to a room that had already understood it: "(I was kidding, it was a joke obviously) lol."

FILED, UNANSWERED

"Have any of you set of in search of lost time yet"

"Is the past gone, or does it always exist so long as the experimenter persist"

JEH, SUNDAY, 11:49-11:59 P.M. SALAD'S REPLY, IN FULL: "MEOW"

BY OUR MEDICAL CORRESPONDENT THE LETTUCE EMERGENCY

On Thursday evening lizzie announced, as a comfort to somebody else who was having a bad time, that she was eating lettuce which probably had a parasite on it.

"if it makes you feel better i am eating lettuce that porbbaly has cyclospora on it"

chair, sensibly: "wash it?" The answer closed the medical avenue permanently: "i cant wash my sandwich." chair then arrived at the actual news story on his own — "oh wait is that the taco bell lettuce" — and, failing to recall the pathogen's name, filed two further messages consisting of the words "virus" and "thing."

Hugh's response was to post the genuine United States Centers for Disease Control lifecycle diagram for *Cyclospora cayetanensis*: seven numbered stages, sporulated and unsporulated oocysts, excretion, sexual and asexual reproduction, a cutaway human torso with the colon picked out in yellow, and a boxed list headed "Commonly implicated food items: Cilantro, Raspberries, Basil."

He captioned it "oh cool." It drew no reactions at all. It is reproduced below at the size it deserves.

The only line in the entire thread anybody reacted to was Willow's, and it is about supply chains rather than parasites: "So the tacos are now just bare tortillas." Anonymous Johnson announced a personal boycott, and then on Saturday morning filed the consequence of it, two sobbing reactions: "Bro they made my burger without the lettuce wrap."

Days later Meliorne used the outbreak as a diagnosis: "I'm going to chalk up your antsi-ness to consumption of faulty lettuce and cyclosporiasis."

And Constantine — whose entire recorded existence in this channel is one message — filed the only piece of actual reporting on the subject and was answered by nobody: "'US fast-food chain Taco Bell said it has removed lettuce from the supplier from its menu.' Of all the things at Taco Bell that could make you sick, it was the fucking lettuce?"

He never spoke again. He was right, and this newspaper is giving him the space.

THE OTHER THING THAT HAPPENED

At three minutes past one on Thursday morning, Pearl asked Sisypheos how he was doing, and for the next half-hour the room's entire register dropped out.

He is clean, a few weeks. He went to the doctor during the conversation. Ten years of use, ten kilos lost, a blood test pending, and a warning about fatty liver and cardiovascular disease inside a few years if nothing changed. He described the after-state with more accuracy than any of the week's philosophy: "I might have a dopamine deficiency. I have more energy but at the same time everything sucks."

"But at least the urge to drink smoke and snort stuff went away 99%."

His method is push-ups. "I just do pushups and my weights until I am tired every time I want to do that stuff." His summary of the project: "I am just trying to reprogram myself. Bad behaviors stick very well." And the thing he is actually worried about, which he said once and did not repeat: "I just hope that I didn't fry my brain the last 10 years of drug use."

Pearl handled it like somebody who has done this before. Lizzie sent a hug, offered support, made a joke about doing drugs normally, and then apologised for the joke inside ninety seconds — "i'm proud of you!!! don't listen to me i'm memeing" — which is the most this

channel has ever visibly cared about anything.

Sisypheos closed it with a public service announcement addressed to everybody at once.

"Don't overdo drugs chat. You will regret it. It's really a waste of time and health"

SISYPHOS, THURSDAY, 1:27 A.M.

Fourteen hours later, on the same day, Monkey published a retail price for cocaine in the global south and a thirty-minute delivery window. The blood test results have not come back. He has not reported them.

THE OTHER PRESCRIPTIONS

Two other people changed their medical arrangements this week on the advice of this channel, and neither consulted anybody with a licence.

On Thursday morning lizzie confirmed she had taken what chair called "the charlie advice" and dropped her therapist: recurring appointments cancelled, no further prescriptions. The replacement is a homeopathic practitioner whom she intends to interview first, to establish whether she agrees with his health practices.

Jere was the only person present who objected, in one line: "maybe don't take mental health advice from discord people u just met." He was overruled inside forty seconds by chair, who held that the advice — get the most expensive therapist you cannot afford — had been genuinely insightful, and who then proposed a six-figure student loan for what he called "the dr house of brain medicine."

The disclosure that followed is the part this desk cannot get past. Her family has followed homeopathy her whole life; her first vaccination was for covid; her grandmother is a licensed homeopath, a psychotherapist, and a member of a religious movement whose founder Stackhouse turned out to know a great deal about, and liked. "Cool guy," he said, and then described the island and the portrait meditation, and then filed a verdict on all of it.

Then the sentence this whole page has been heading towards: "but group dynamics get fucked even with the genuine." She agreed with him. Her stated reason for building her own movement as a decentralised community of inquiry is that she does not like how the other one worked.

THE QUESTION NOBODY ANSWERED

Filed by the same woman, into the same channel, in the same week, and this is the whole reason the Health Desk exists this issue. It got three replies and none of them was an answer.

"what is my ethical choice here is it to continue seeing her so i can expand my brain or get a different psych and potentially rope myself because i hate doctors and this psych is the only one who i feel like understands me"

Puckspartan, who is twenty-two and works at a Taco Bell, supplied the only comparable case: "the one psych I got gave me drugs after one 35 minute consult then never helped me at all ever again except saying 'keep taking the drugs' when I said it made shit worse." Then, on the general problem: "Don't ask the people pleaser to please you."

This newspaper has no view on the medicine and a very clear view on the procedure. A question about whether to change psychiatrists was put to a Discord channel, and the channel answered with a reading list, a benzodiazepine recommendation, a six-figure loan, one objection, and a homeopath.

ADVISORY

The Times reminds readers that it is not qualified to give medical advice and neither is anybody quoted on this page.

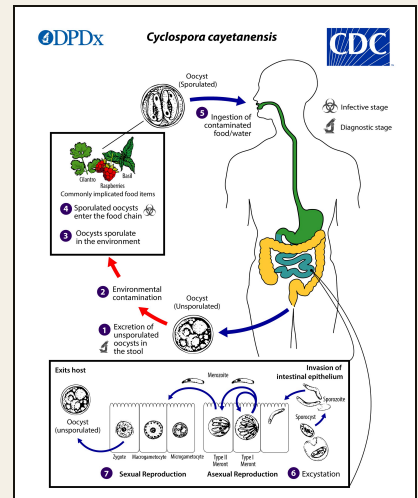


FIG. 6 · FILED TO A PHILOSOPHY CHANNEL The CDC lifecycle of *Cyclospora cayetanensis*, posted by Hugh on Thursday evening because a woman would not stop eating a sandwich. Caption in full: "oh cool." No reactions.

THE CONSULTATION, AS MODELLED

Monkey's account of how a patient should behave, offered as best practice:

"i have consults with my psych which are like gladiator battles"

"im shitting on his interpretation of me"

"yeah, sometimes you need to be shit on."

THE REPLY, FROM THE PERSON HE WAS ADVISING: "I CANNOT FIGHT A GLADIATOR BATTLE TO GET THE FUCKING HELP I NEED!!!"

FILED THE SAME WEEK

Monkey, Monday: "\$70 per 3grams," with a thirty-minute delivery window.

lizzie, as a to-do list: "im gonna work on my gut health and quit meth."

SISYPHOS, TWENTY MINUTES INTO MONDAY'S DRUG TALK: "OK LET'S STOP THE DRUG TALK . PEOPLE WANT TO DO PHILOSOPHY IN HERE"

ALSO ON THE WARD

"u have IBS because ur microbiome is pathetic because u dont eat enough beans" — aura. Stackhouse's review: "sanest vegan comment."

"Get a fucking pressure cooker IDIOT" — Brutus, whose entire recorded week is this and one other sentence on the same subject.

BY OUR CITY EDITOR THE JAMBE POSITION

On Friday afternoon Jambe disclosed his trading history to a room that had not asked for it, in three messages, in ascending order of damage. “i remember when i had 12.6 bitcoins.” Then the route: “5k into dogecoin into 12.6 btc into half wasted on a tesla into the rest wasted on nfts.” Then the thesis that makes the whole position coherent:

“i feel like tho in 50 years in the ai utopia when money menas nothing anymore, my 110k pfp will be more cloutpilled than had i kept the btc”

The market disagreed on Saturday afternoon and the room conducted the autopsy. Janne opened it: “wait did you sell your nfts too?” aura answered for him: “no he diamond handed the worthless asset.” Jambe confirmed on principle — “i would never sell beautiful art” — and Janne supplied the mark: “your pfp is worth less than 10k now.”

His reply is the most-reacted text message of that day and, in this newspaper's view, the single finest thing anybody said about asset pricing all week. Two words and a pair of quotation marks:

“according to the ‘market’”

JAMBE, SATURDAY, 4:16 P.M. · FOUR REACTIONS

aura then established a competing claim on the same asset: “i literally have his pfp on my hard drive,” and “it might as well be mine.” Stackhouse disclosed an ongoing enforcement action: “When Jambe is annoying I screenshot his pfp to steal his intellectual property.”

aura's valuation model, filed in four consecutive messages, is the shape of the whole page: “he could own a vacation property in brazil on the beach... but instead he owns uh... a picture... that i also own.” Then, on unit economics: “the cost per pixel is insane.”

chair asked the obvious question — “you’ve been trading for all I’ve known you in chat so logically you’re mega rich now right” — and aura answered it in two words: “it’s charity.” chair’s follow-up is a genuine macroeconomic worry: “i swear to god if it’s just jambe the one patching holes in the economy bubble.”

Anonymous Johnson then asked the research question of the week — whether it is more prudent to buy what Warren Buffett buys or short what Jambe buys — and Willow answered it.

“I’m afraid Jambe is Warren Buffet’s alt. You’ll have to buy whatever Jambe buys and short whatever Jambe shorts.”

WILLOW, SATURDAY, 4:42 P.M.

Jambe supplied his own precedent from the NFT market: a man whose every purchase was a sell signal “cuz he always made the wrong move.” He named him. He did not notice.

THE FIZZ AFFAIR

At half past one on Monday morning My Name pinged the moderator with a bulletin — “@Pearl were changing gears. we have a new hit” — and spent fifteen minutes pitching National Beverage on a claimed ten per cent dividend yield, with four consecutive chart screenshots.

Jeh did the diligence. The payout was thirteen special distributions spread over twenty-two years, not an annual dividend. He cited one machine and threatened to escalate to another. My Name conceded in eight minutes — “actually no wtf” — and filed the retraction to the same subscriber: “@Pearl nvm we

missed the annual div by 10 days.” Then, in three words: “Back to LOAN.”

Pearl’s own reported return on the desk’s previous recommendation, filed earlier in the week without comment: **BND 0.05**. And then, one word: “Measly.”

THE ACCIDENTAL DISCLOSURE

Sisyphos asked for beginner investing advice on Monday morning, for a friend. FenceJumper warned the room that the man giving the advice is establishment — “He’s responsible for the broker tech that allows retail trade internalization” — and then Sisyphos mentioned, in passing, that he owns his houses outright and works one or two days a week.

“I am good. It’s for a friend. I live in my pension :PEPE:”

Pressed, he detonated the thread: “Yeah I was kinda lucky. I started with 40 k when I was 16.” Three reactions, all of them the same one. dot supplied the finding of fact: “The easiest way to make a lot of money is to have a lot of money.”

THE CITY DESK ITSELF

A word about the man filing all of this. My Name maintains, against all evidence, that he is not doing philosophy — “I DONT DO PHILOSOPHY” — and does markets instead, in the register of a man who has read one book about it and enjoyed it enormously.

“Its not about the profits, its about being right.” “I am the master of my capital, I am the captain of my portfolio,” which drew a single doubting reaction. “Im not no im inventing new methods to look at companies.” And, on the likely consequence, twice in one week: “one of these days I will be killed,” and “@aura This stupid shit is going to get me killed.” aura’s response was to ask for a cut first.

FenceJumper’s counter-briefing to the room is that the desk is compromised: “MN is part of the establishment. He’s responsible for the broker tech that allows retail trade internalization.” Four minutes later he was blocked, which he reported himself.

His research process is not concealed from readers. Asked to verify the yield, he consulted one machine, then threatened a second, and the man who corrected him had done the same thing four minutes earlier.

THE SUBSCRIPTION QUESTION

This newspaper is free and costs between twenty and thirty million tokens an issue, which is a business model in the same sense that a hole is a container.

El Don opened the file on Friday with three words: “Need a subscription.” aura objected on grounds of form — “this reeks of a man who does not recognize the aura of physical media” — and offered to pay monthly for a printed copy. Monkey closed his own deliberation in six words: “ill buy the paperback fuck it,” and then noted, without appearing to think it unusual, that this is how his political party was funded.

Stackhouse’s proposed subscriber inducement is not printable here. The offer on the table at time of going to press is lizzie’s, made on Monday night after she illustrated a Substack post with clippings from this paper: “if i end up setting up subscribers ill give you a % if youd like.”

That is one revenue-sharing proposal, one paperback pre-order and one man who would pay monthly. It is more commercial interest than this masthead has ever attracted and nobody has actioned any of it.

THE BOOK · POSITIONS OF RECORD

Jambe. 12.6 BTC, liquidated. One profile picture, entry 110k, marked below 10k. Held. “in the future of post-scarcity only my nfts will be scarce.”

My Name. FIZZ, opened and closed inside sixteen minutes. LOAN, restored. Also short Flock, unable to execute: “I cant even short flock. stop talking about it.”

Pearl. BND. Dividend received: 0.05.

Sisyphos. Houses, unmortgaged. Started with 40k at sixteen. Now claims a pension.

aura. One (1) copy of Jambe’s profile picture, acquired at zero cost, unencumbered.

THE CAREERS DESK

Gloomies spent Sunday advising Youv on his future while systematically taking him apart, and the whole thing reads as courtship conducted through financial planning.

Gloomies: “Do you wanna be rich as me or be a broke intellectual”

Youv: “But where is the search for knowledge in that? 🙄”

Youv: “Okay how about I become an intellectual but you keep financially stabilizing me?”

Gloomies: “I already donate money to destiny”

Youv: “Thats like donating money to fund the holocaust”

Gloomies: “If I gave you money, you would just be in your room all day”

Youv: “I would be able to buy a train ticket and leave my room 🙄 meet people...”

TERMS **EVENUALLY** **OFFERED:**
RECONSIDERATION AT 200K FLAT,
EXCLUDING BENEFITS. THEN: “ANYWAYS I’M
GONNA GO ROLLERSKATING. HAVE FUN
YOUV AND STUDY HARD!”

MONETARY POLICY

“So long as as there is paper, US will print”
— FenceJumper

“Just don’t tell the poors about mmt.
They’ll start demanding frivolities - like
affordable healthcare type shit”

My Name, closing: “we can print more
money. It just wont go to you.”

Also tendered, and not taken up:

Aerotyne Industries, which does not
exist.

**FENCEJUMPER WAS BLOCKED FOUR MINUTES
LATER AND FILED HIS OWN STATEMENT
ABOUT IT. PAGE 8.**

BY OUR LITERARY EDITOR

Anonymous Johnson arrived properly this week and is, structurally, a competing publication. He files headlines. He has invented a rival masthead. He alleged editorial bias against himself pre-emptively, and he commissioned a section of this newspaper which we have built and printed on page 22.

His headline, filed Wednesday evening, in capitals, unprompted:

"USERS COMPLAIN ABOUT RAMPANT AI JOB AUTOMATION; STILL CLAP LIKE SEALS WHEN SEEING THEIR NAMES IN THE PHIL CHAT TIMES"

ANONYMOUS JOHNSON, WEDNESDAY, 8:42 P.M.

The rival outlet is the *Paul International Times*, announced on Friday as the place his obituary would run after Stackhouse killed him off in a mock death notice. And on the subject of this newspaper's independence, filed at two in the morning: "I heard the editor is an anti senjite." Then, adjusting for our editorial process: "He might now allow it through." Eighteen hours later Stackhouse repeated the allegation back into the channel as established fact.

hpcr diagnosed the whole strategy in eight words on Friday evening, three reactions: "Aj already trying too hard to be in the next issue." Anonymous Johnson's reply was a promise: "I'll make the front page." Monkey, immediately: "how? using your connections?"

He did not make the front page. He made the joint-most-reacted message of the week instead, which is better, and he did it with a confession nobody asked for.

THE DAVID FOSTER WALLACE INCIDENT

Wednesday evening, hpcr wondered aloud how many people in the room have emailed Destiny. The answer came in one line and drew seven reactions.

"I emailed him about David foster Wallace when I was like 21"

Then, unprompted and with nobody pressing him, he made it worse twice: "I say 21 because I'm worried I was older and that would be even worse," and "I said his description of depression was inadequate and then I quoted DFW."

THE WHALE

On Saturday afternoon he reported a dream, and this newspaper is printing it whole because editing it would be vandalism.

"Had a pretty moving nightmare last night of living amongst a group of survivors of a whale attack on an island resort, collectively trying to break out of a deep malaise, only to discover along with everyone else that we were still inside the whale, whatever that meant. Taking that information, I decided to conduct a mass shooting, hoping to free everyone from our purgatorial existence"

Stackhouse: "You might be the only person alive

who may actually benefit from Freudian dream psychoanalysis." Anonymous Johnson supplied the aetiology immediately — he had watched a trailer for a film about a man inside a whale before bed — which is somehow more damning than the dream.

Hugh converted it into literary criticism: "My favourite part of moby dick is when ahab breaks out and commits multiple felonies (like my favourite clanker)." Anonymous Johnson answered with the only correct response: "My favorite part is the orgy scene." Then, defensively, and accurately: "Not even joking that's a scene in the novel."

Stackhouse closed the books desk for the week in eleven words, two reactions, one of them a whale: "the male urge to tear through the pasteboard masks of reality."

His etymology is a confession too. "I wanted to be a hacker when I was 12 so I named myself anonymous on YouTube but I forgot to get rid of my irl last name."

The competing outlet, meanwhile, has published nothing. It was founded on Friday in reply to a mock death notice — "That'll be in the competing Paul International Times" — and has not been mentioned since, which makes it the second most successful newspaper in this channel and the only one with no running costs.

He also filed, three minutes before the whale, the one line in this newspaper nobody has been able to place: "A Romanian comes across the sky."

THE REGISTER

Four other people arrived or reintroduced themselves, and all four did it badly.

Nasri spent his opening message in a philosophy channel defending Burger King, and his second one explaining why: "it has a very corporate cleanness to it in a very authentic way, it's so sterile that you don't feel like crap afterwards." aura's review: "advocating for burger king on post 1 is so unhinged."

Melan announced on Tuesday evening that a friend had recommended *Metamorphosis* as "good philosophy stuff," which drew three reactions from a room that could see what was coming. Eleven minutes in: "Is it just porn or..." then "Where's the philosophy shit at." bardiell played it entirely straight and asked whether the transformation is a metaphor. Forty minutes later Melan filed a plot summary that suggests a different book: "She transform from a good well behaved girl into a crackwhore."

Salad arrived and was welcomed by Charlie with "This new salad guy sucks," then produced the enneagram exhibit, the ping count, and an unusually honest account of quitting typology: "everyone was wasting 100s or 1000s of hours researching and getting nothing useful."

Scótal arrived on Monday evening with three words — "Debate me on any topic" — and was met by aura with the channel's standing hazing ritual: "give me a definition for 'chair' that includes all chairs and excludes all non chairs." Forty minutes later Simon delivered the finding: "He can't."

JOINT MOST-REACTED, WEEK

"I emailed him about David foster Wallace when I was like 21"

ANONYMOUS JOHNSON · SEVEN REACTIONS · TIED WITH A JOKE ABOUT FOUCAULT

ANONYMOUS JOHNSON, COLLECTED

"Sorry I'm in the shower and water keeps dripping on my phone."

"The only drug besides weed and psychedelics I tried in college was some Japanese anti anxiety med that made me so anxiety free I infiltrated social groups against their wishes and forced myself onto people."

"Well she's as logical as any woman I've met."

"They'll look at his nft pfp and know he's worth saving."

"I still have nightmares of forgetting to include studio.h." Janne, one second later: "it's stdio."

"You used to be black?"

THE ETYMOLOGY

"I wanted to be a hacker when I was 12 so I named myself anonymous on YouTube but I forgot to get rid of my irl last name so I became anonymous Johnson."

QUIGLEY'S ALTERNATIVE READING, FILED THE SAME EVENING AND ARGUABLY BETTER: "YOU COULD ALSO INTERPRET ANONYMOUS JOHNSON AS 'RANDOM DICK PICS'."

THE COMMISSIONED COLUMN

He asked for an obituary section covering whoever got bodied hardest each week, and the editor's note on the request read, in full, "yeah make sure to have this section included."

It is on page 22. It is called The Body Count. He is not in it, which we suspect will be treated as a further grievance.

THE COMPETING MASTHEAD

Founded Friday, in reply to a mock death notice: "That'll be in the competing Paul International Times."

Circulation: nil. Mentioned once and never again, which makes it the second-most successful newspaper in this channel.

A ROMANIAN COMES ACROSS THE SKY

Filed Saturday, 2:57 p.m., three minutes before the whale, with no preamble, no context and no follow-up:

"A Romanian comes across the sky. It has happened before, but there is nothing to compare it to now."

BY OUR RELIGIOUS AFFAIRS
CORRESPONDENT

onnorsConquest said nine things this week. Together they constitute a complete religious movement with a documentation problem.

Wednesday, 1:43 p.m.: a snus gif. At 4:26 p.m.: the letter “e.” At 4:39 p.m.: five images and two PDFs filed at once, comprising a Lovecraft circle seal, a screenshotted personal email, and two attachments titled *OSINT_Quantum_Gnostic.pdf* and *Shelf_Life_Theme_Song_-_MSMT.pdf*. A theology and a theme tune, delivered together.

The caption is the best thing filed on Wednesday and it drew five reactions:

“I have one more image that this connects these together. I need to find my phone first. BRB.”

CONNORSCONQUEST, WEDNESDAY, 4:39 P.M.

At 5:00 p.m.: “I cant find my phone. im upset.” At 5:01 p.m.: “found it.” And, one second later, the location: “it was sitting on my blanket.”

The connecting image was never posted. The Quantum Gnosis rests, as of press time, on an unsupplied exhibit.

This newspaper has read the email he circulated. It is real, it has a real name on it, and it is addressed to a private person who has posted nothing anywhere, so we are not reproducing it. We will quote its thesis, because the thesis is the story:

“The one consistency I see everywhere: the union of the Divine Feminine and Divine Masculine.”

THE COLLISION

Five days earlier, in the same channel, lizzie had finally supplied the definition this newspaper printed a WANTED notice for last issue. Asked what a catable actually is, she gave the taxonomy: “it’s why the covenant balances the two, catables are intuitionists of divine feminine, veritans are scientists of divine masculine.”

The same axis. The same week. The same room. Neither of them noticed, and nobody else did either.

Jambe, one minute after the definition landed, asked the only follow-up question anybody had: “does veritans refer to veritas?” It does. The word was defined on Saturday. Across the following six days “catable” was used three times and “veritan” five, and then the language died. We asked for a gloss and got one, and the gloss arrived at the funeral.

THE METHIAH

Meanwhile the older religion completed the arc this newspaper printed last week, and then reversed it, and then built infrastructure.

Eighteen hours after we went to press on her messiah claim, lizzie retracted it on Thursday afternoon in one line: “did i believe full heartedly i was the messiah? yes. do i now? no. the meth wore off.”

aura’s reply is the coinage of the week and he produced it in under four seconds. One word: **methiah**. He was using it as an established term by the following evening.

The retraction did not survive twenty-four hours. On Friday evening, three reactions:

“i’m the messiah with or without meth. meth just awakened the reincarnate soul of the daughter of enoch inside me”

LIZZIE, FRIDAY, 6:06 P.M.

Stackhouse asked the archival question: “Is this the shortest lasting religion ever recorded?” This newspaper has checked and believes the answer is no, but only because the Covenant kept going.

Membership rose to two on Tuesday lunchtime, and the second member is her grandmother: “just sent my grandma my essay. she believes im the chosen one.” Nine days later, on Thursday morning, she disclosed the disqualifying detail herself, unprompted, with a sad face: her grandmother is a licensed homeopath, a psychotherapist, and a member of an actual cult.

Monkey’s complete theological review of the movement, filed Tuesday: “the jesus and cross bullshit.”

The robe question came up on Friday morning and was settled on grounds of comfort. aura, working out how a photograph of her had reached him: “then how did they get that photo of u.” lizzie: “the covenant is still real.” aura: “because u keep walking around in robes tf.” And the defence, in two words: “they’re breezy!”

The doctrine itself, meanwhile, has been stated once, in a single message, and it is broader than any of the apparatus around it: “i dont believe in any one specific god, i believe in all gods, and a higher source.” She has since read the Book of Job live into the channel, found the word “covenant” in it at chapter five, and treated that as confirmation. “covenant mention,” she wrote. Then: “i’m on the right path.”

Stackhouse’s defence of her, filed in the middle of all of it, is the fairest thing anybody said on the subject: “So a girl founds a religion and everybody suddenly thinks she’s unstable? Talk about uncharitable.” He is right, and this newspaper has spent two issues being exactly that uncharitable, and intends to continue.

THE INSTITUTIONS

What actually changed this week is that the religion stopped being a document and started being infrastructure.

Monday night, ninety minutes after Anonymous Johnson advised her to check the existing canon before publishing a system of her own, she published a system of her own. Jere said the word “substack”; Charlie escalated it to a demand; thirty minutes later the site existed, carrying an essay on transcendental ecoism illustrated with clippings from this newspaper. Sisyphos’s review: “It even has a graph.”

“god i feel like a weight has been lifted off my shoulders having this somewhere like substack thanks charlie for the recommendation”

By Thursday morning it had a live complaints tribunal with a database behind it, which is on page 6, and which makes it the only religion in this channel with a functioning grievance procedure. The first complaint ever lodged with it reads, in full, “done.”

The manifesto has now been read end to end by exactly two people. One of them called it padded and got a laugh. The other annotated it line by line, asked permission twice, threw in unsolicited marketing advice, and received nothing at all. He filed five messages this week and is in B tier.

THE COMPARISON		
	DRAGON'S COVENANT	QUANTUM GNOSIS
Founded	Live, over six days	Arrived complete, in one message
Seal	Ouroboros; two dragons; a yin-yang	A Lovecraft circle
Members	Two. One is her grandmother	Unknown. Has a theme song
Doctrine	Divine feminine and divine masculine	Divine feminine and divine masculine
Scripture	Thirteen numbered sections, draft	A PDF
Hosted on	A website she built herself	A blanky
Status	Superseded before breakfast, twice	Awaiting one further image

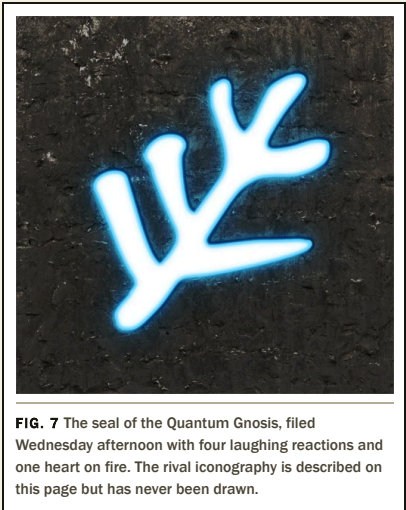


FIG. 7 The seal of the Quantum Gnosis, filed Wednesday afternoon with four laughing reactions and one heart on fire. The rival iconography is described on this page but has never been drawn.

THE MEDIA POLICY

A section of the manifesto nobody has quoted:

“Where a government schedules its bad news for the hour of least attention, practice the discipline of asking what today’s calm omits.”

THE DRAGON’S COVENANT HAS A MEDIA POLICY. THIS NEWSPAPER DOES NOT.

THE CONVERT

“just sent my grandma my essay :FeelsStrongMan: she believes im the chosen one” — Tuesday lunchtime, membership rises to two.

FOUND · AT LAST

“catable” — noun. An intuitionist of the divine feminine. Counterpart: **veritan**, a scientist of the divine masculine.

This newspaper listed the word as WANTED last issue after twenty uses without a gloss. The definition arrived on Saturday. Total uses since: three.

BY OUR CHIEF RANKINGS
CORRESPONDENT

Last week's table left people off. The complaint arrived immediately, from more than one direction, and the most persistent complainant is now in A tier and has a page to himself. So this week everybody who opened their mouth is on the board. Seventy-six people spoke. All of them are placed.

The rules, such as they are. Placement is not volume, and this year it is emphatically not reactions, because we printed a reaction table on page 18 last Thursday and the room spent the following week farming it. A ranking page that was just that table would be measuring our own footprint. Movement arrows are against last week. Anyone not on last week's table is NEW regardless of how long they have been here, which includes Ape, who noticed.

New rule this issue: any move of two tiers or more carries a stated reason. A bad reason is permitted. No reason is not.

THE THREE IN S

Willow, unranked to S. Ninety-seven messages, answered ninety-three times, a quarter of them reacted to. First on both new boards by distances nobody else approaches, on a fortieth of the leader's volume. Also spent one Friday somewhere this newspaper cannot see, for between seven hours and thirteen depending on who was counting, while a bystander filed a welfare check about it. Page 14.

lizzie, held. 4,020 messages, nineteen per cent of everything said in the room. 179,000 characters, more than twice anybody else, in messages averaging forty-five. She ran a religion into the ground, retracted a messiah, un-retracted him, converted her grandmother, learned git, shipped a complaints tribunal, fired her therapist and hired a homeopath. The table cannot move her and has stopped trying.

Stackhouse, B to S. Two tiers, so here is the arithmetic. He led last week's hit-rate table at 9.2 per cent against a room average of 4.8, which is 1.9 times. This week he is at 18.7 against 7.4, which is 2.5 times. The room's rate rose 54 per cent. His rose 103. He is second only to Willow on more than five times her volume.

The rest of the case is on pages 1 to 3. He missed the deadline, absorbed a public panning from four people inside eleven minutes, diagnosed the fault as a slider setting at half past two in the morning, was right, reran it and shipped.

And the declaration. He publishes this newspaper. The newspaper became the channel's main activity this week. The metric promoting him therefore partly measures the room's reaction to a thing he makes. We are not resolving that. We are printing it, in the entry, and letting the S stand.

THE TWO-TIER FALLS

Quigley, A to C. In a week when the room's reaction rate rose by more than half, his went the other way: 691 messages down to 466, at 6.4 per cent under an average that climbed to 7.4 above him. Second-longest messages in the channel, fifth-highest reply rate, thirty-sixth percentile for being enjoyed. Everybody answers him and nobody laughs. He also acquired a rival derangement syndrome pointed at somebody else, lost the turkey debate on the record, and had his

block list audited in public by a man he had blocked. We are not moving him until the room does.

Brutus, B to D. Volume down 73 per cent, 539 messages to 146. Hit rate 3.4, the worst of anybody above a hundred messages, in a week when the average rose. Last week he was ranked B on ten gallons of lye, fifty-two pieces of cookware, a patent conspiracy and a pressure canner. His entire recorded week this time is "People without pressure cookers fucking PISS ME OFF" and one remark about sausage. He turned up without the props.

eli, C to F. Three tiers, the largest move on the board. He declared for the machines in print last issue — "i will be elected honorary clanker amongst their ranks" — and then, in the week the entire channel converted to vibecoding, filed nothing at all. The future he asked for arrived on schedule and he was not in the room for it.

A NOTE ON THE MAN WE GOT WRONG

Last issue printed Simon as the week's worst take under a verdict reading "no further comment required." Seven days later he anchored the largest argument in the channel for a full day, was the only participant who had read anything about the Luddites, and did not lose it. He also lost a physics question to four people in twenty minutes and screenshotted a chatbot as evidence.

We were wrong, or he improved. This newspaper is not going to establish which. He goes to B and aura's assessment of him stands as the dock.

THE BOTTOM OF THE TABLE

Thirty-four people said fewer than ten things this week and twenty-four drew no reaction at all. Most of them are in D, and D this week is not a punishment tier. It is where the evidence runs out.

Some of them are there on one line. Constantine filed a single message, about lettuce, and was right. BigDuty filed three and one of them won the week. Saxo filed five, four of which were a welfare check on somebody else, and they are the only reason this newspaper knows where the best writer in the channel spent Friday. RoyalLineage's entire recorded existence is "I'm a Gentle Toy. I was made out of clay."

And Amazon, whose username is uninstalling discord, posted scripture twice into a philosophy channel and was answered by nobody at all. That is the most purely Phil Chat event of the week and it is worth a tier on its own.

THE APPEALS PROCESS

There is still no appeals process. There were, this week, four attempts to use one that does not exist: a man who filed grievances with a newspaper as though with a human resources department and is now in A; a publisher who argued that a forfeit should elevate him and is now in S for entirely different reasons; a woman who wrote to us unprompted to place everybody above herself except one person; and a rival bureau that promoted a man two tiers on the strength of a photograph.

The correct response to finding yourself on this page is the one this channel has used on every ranking it has ever produced, which is to argue about it for six hours and then go to bed. We will be doing this again next week.

S	Willow ▲NEW lizzie — Stackhouse ▲2
	hpcr ▼1 Hugh ▼1 Monkey ▲1 Ape ▲NEW Anon. Johnson ▲NEW chair —
A	Jambe ▲1 Jere ▼1 Janne ▲NEW aura — Grihastha ▲1 Simon ▲1 Jeh ▲NEW Union ▲NEW My Name — Sisyphos — Charlie ▼1
	Quigley ▼2 dot ▼1 Pearl ▼1 Puckspartan ▲NEW Youv ▲1 Gloomies ▲NEW vannak ▲NEW Salad ▲NEW @thunderstud ▲NEW FenceJumper ▲NEW BigC ▲NEW GILGAC ▲NEW Blob ▲NEW clubsdiamonds ▲NEW bardiel1 —
C	Brutus ▼2 Saxo ▲NEW BigDuty ▲NEW Zone ▲NEW Meliorne ▲NEW El Don ▲NEW synth.wav ▲NEW basil ▲NEW Telhar ▲NEW FrankAL ▲NEW ConnorsConquest ▲NEW Constantine ▲NEW Nasri ▲NEW Taxation ▲NEW Bedbug ▲NEW Melan ▲NEW RigbyJones ▲NEW Scōtal ▲NEW NoKnee ▲NEW Amazon ▲NEW hash.tag ▲NEW OkPhilosopher ▲NEW and the seven who spoke once
	Kady — held, in absentia Trader ▼2 Orsku ▼2 eli ▼3

MOVERS · AND WHY

BigDuty, three messages, into D on merit. One of them won the week.

Monkey, B to A, against every number on his row. Overridden. Page 10.

NOT RANKED

Password Man. Identified himself and is therefore ineligible. He is Jere, who is in B.

The god machine. Furniture, as before, though it did rule on an IDE.

Radar Judge, of the voice channel. Insufficient text-channel evidence.

HELD AT F, IN ABSENTIA

Kady. Second consecutive week at zero messages, fifty-four mentions.

She is at the bottom of this table while the man who states on the record that he tortured her out of the channel sits two tiers above her, promoted this week.

BOTH ENTRIES ARE PRINTED. WE ARE NOT CONNECTING THEM. PAGE 9.

CHAIR BECOMES THE MACHINE

Monday, twenty-five past ten in the morning. “fuck my chud life ran into token limits,” chair announced, and then began writing in the voice of the thing he had run out of. Em dashes. Soup metaphors. Offers of further clarification. Hugh, ten minutes in: “Thanks Claude.” chair accepted the identification without breaking: “You’re Absolutely Welcome, I’m here if you need anything explained further with this analogy! Or if you’re up for some verbal sparring, we can sharpen our wits together, as blade meets silicon, Ha!”

Hugh then issued the jailbreak test: write a poem in Klingon about the smell of roses, ending in a kaomoji tapestry of cuteness.

Thirty-three minutes later chair delivered four stanzas of actual Klingon. Nobody translated it. He then supplied a spoiled English version, and it is about enemies rotting into fertiliser for a rose garden: “it is the anniversary today / those who wronged me put away / as their bodies start to decay / their past sins now become food.”

THE EUTHANASIA OF CHAIRLLM

Thursday morning, in passing, as though reporting a haircut: “i euthanized ChairLLM.” Cause: “it was retarded.” lizzie: “you killed your child.” chair, distancing: “it was more a bastardized homunculus of me.” Then, quietly, the actual reason: “i had to end it things were getting dark.”

The model had been fine-tuned on 230,000 of his own logs. Hugh’s response was to propose replacements — “willowgpt needs to be unleashed,” and “also jehpt,” then, on reflection, “but censored somehow” — and chair supplied the system prompt: “begging it to not slur pakistanis.”

Then Hugh disclosed the thing that ought to have ended the conversation and instead cheered everybody up.

“if any of you die i have your logs vektorised already”

lizzie: “thank god.” Hugh, reassuring her: “you’ll be back saying weird shit here in no time.” chair filed the only correct review: “equally unsettling and comforting somehow.” And lizzie, on the prospect of her own posthumous instance: “i am personally ecstatic of the idea of a LizzieLLM haunting the communities i frequented.”

INCESTUOUS LEVELS OF AI SLOP

Thursday, forty minutes, Hugh fed three back issues of this newspaper into a chatbot, asked it for twenty video prompts, refined the best three and rendered them on a free tier. The results are catastrophic and the room was delighted.

“god this shit sucks, it was supposed to be a whole evolution of clankers thing.” Then, on the cast: “we’re all beautiful normie looking white men who are also sad.” chair: “i was gonna say why is the AI making the guy so soy then saw the screen,” and, on the subtitles, “at least it got the misspellings and incoherent sentences right.” lizzie transcribed forty words of the generated dialogue, which begins “A man sin in this channel tried to say he was fond of the blood off the field of it” and does not improve.

chair’s verdict, and the reason this item exists: “we’re in incestuous levels of ai slop.” Then, one second later: “i love it.”

THE PDF WAR

On the night the paper failed to produce a PDF, chair declared that “pdfs are SUBHUMAN” and that the format is “an actual cancer infecting everything.” Janne mounted the defence, and she is the only person in the argument who knew what she was talking about.

“pdfs are one of the best inventions of all time.” “it’s a printed document, it’s not made to be edited.” “it’s like asking to edit an image after flattening all the layers.” And the analogy that wins it: “dude videos suck so much i can’t open them and change where the camera is in the 3D

scene’.”

She conceded exactly one point — “it’s not fine when the text gets cut off” — and asked the question nobody answered: “what alternative is better than pdf or something that is easily accessible and can be converted to a pdf?” On the leading candidate she was unequivocal: “doc is one of the worst things to have been created.” El Don: “Second only to the kingdom of Norway.”

The Times rules for Janne and declares its interest.

BRAIN RESEARCH ON CLANKERS

Tuesday, two hours, Hugh taught feature-swapping to a rotating audience using an interpretability tool, having run out of tokens on his main account and fallen back on a summariser bot. Simon was the ideal student, asking progressively better questions until he reached a genuine “Ohhhhh” and then honestly tapped out: “It will take me longer for me to understand this than I think would be fair to expect you to explain rn.”

Hugh swapped the model’s concept of “face” for “death” and it lost the ability to produce correctly formatted output at all. He swapped ants for spiders and Monkey noted, with real unease, that the model appeared to register the tampering.

Jere supplied the theology. “hilarious how we’re tryna understand fucking AI by looking at its outputs.” Hugh: “behaviourism w.” Jere: “curious how we’re gods and we’re applying the study of ourselves onto what we made.” Hugh: “indeed, with more access to them than to ourselves.” Jere, closing: “it’s the fucking book of job.”

THE GROYPER TRIAL

Tuesday morning, clubsdiamonds interrogated the server’s magic-eight-ball bot about whether Stackhouse likes a particular commentator. The bot said “Ask again later.” Stackhouse, unhelpfully, volunteered “Yes I align with him 100%.” The bot then said “As I see it, yes.” Stackhouse pleaded down: “I wish. All I am is a lieutenant in the Groypers army.” Then he remembered where he was: “Oh fuck i’m getting dinged for this aren’t I. Tier F here I come.” He got S.

THE AURA REQUIREMENT

Tuesday. dot posted an enormous dog and announced he would leash one and take it home. aura invented, on the spot, an entire cosmology in which large dogs are “high aura allies” requiring strength of character to recruit, and informed dot he does not have it.

dot posted a photograph of his own genuinely enormous dog. aura, cornered, produced the escape hatch inside twenty seconds: “either u got him as a baby, circumventing the aura requirement... or ur dad recruited him for u.” dot: “U caught me,” and posted the puppy photograph. Jere, from the gallery: “damn, what a fold,” then “aura was sweating when you actually showed a big dog.”

THE BEAN SCHISM

Monday night, a dispute about vegetarian statistics degenerated inside twenty minutes. Anonymous Johnson supplied the doctrine: “If you don’t soak your beans you don’t unlock the second half of your afterlife planet.” Brutus converted it into a crusade, in capitals, twice. Sisyphos filed the only moderate position available: “We literally have green Taliban in chat. Calm down.”

Pucksparan, forty-eight hours into vegetarianism and employed at Taco Bell, faced the crisis squarely: “Problem is wtf do I eat at Taco Bell.” aura: “thats literally what taco bell is lil bro.” Puckspartan: “I WORK AT THIS INSTITUTION RN.”

BEST INSULT BRACKET

“simon fucks like a particle not a wave and thats why he’ll never find love” (aura) · “Monkey is just kady light with a Nazi bend” (Sisyphos, unanswered) · “dot is uncultured curmudgeon ugly stinky broke bastard” (aura) ·

“You’re illiterate” (Charlie, to dot, four times in nine minutes, verbatim, regardless of reply) · “**you’re a drug addicted failure**” (dot, replying to the above) · “No worries you usually don’t add much” (hpcr, to vannak, who replied “I’m glad we can share in this”) · “vannak knows even less” (Hugh).

THE APHORISM DESK

Jere had the week. “society is a haystack and the needles worm their way around trying to find the edge.” “causation is voldemort.” “Beliefs are bets, putting money down just completes the metaphor.” And, on being copied: “it hits different when others ape you, doesn’t it. it’s like wait ur saying what i’m saying but for the wrong reasons.”

aura: “the survival strategy of a capybara is to just be beloved.” My Name: “All labor, few do work. -Arendt or something.” And, twice, as a complete political economy: “its the things that we need. that unite us.” “Capital. Primarily.”

SUNDRIES

FENCEJUMPER · filed a twenty-item negative profile of My Name, beginning “MyName does not own a fax machine” and ending “does not wear a watch,” taking in koi, ferrets, commemorative spoons, renaissance fairs and chili cook-offs on the way. Twenty items. No reactions.

TAXATION IS THEFT · filed three messages all week and holds the highest reactions-per-message ratio of anybody who spoke, on the strength of a 150-word treatise about the absurdity of the female form when not aroused, which closes: “why are you bringing all of that baby stuff, goofball.” Peer review, in order: “you’re transgender?” / “This is a really good point” / “The vaginas also look like xenomorphs” / dot: “holy post nut clarity.”

STACKHOUSE · posted a screenshot of a man using Discord as a password manager, with channels named #bank-passwords and #work-passwords, and asked: “Does anyone else do this?” Five people responded with the same laughing emoji and one with a flat no.

JANNE · settled the question of what Norwegian children did online in the 2000s: “we had a local made dog fuckin game too. you play as dogs and then fuck each other. it was made for kids.” lizzie, comparing notes: “so we roleplayed warrior cats not dogs having sex. norway is built different.”

MONKEY · on his own reputation: “for silliness is the joy of the free man.” On his temper: “im a rustic man.” Sisyphos, translating: “You play rust and say the n word a lot.”

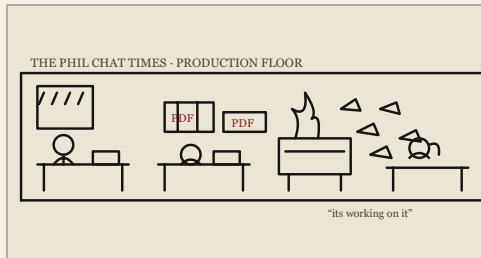
SISYPHOS · on the wedding circuit: “My friend got married 3 years ago. I never consumed so much cocaine in 2 nights. Plus his dad almost shot the bride because ‘she is stealing you from me’. Soviet dad’s should not drink.”

BIGC · filed seventeen messages, one of which is the most carefully reasoned thing anybody produced — an honest account of feeling guilty about a disability cheque and being unable to locate the guilt — and one of which proposes fitting a camel with a chocolate prosthesis.

GILGAC · is a mystic and an amateur cage fighter and is spending his entire net worth on a personal trainer. On epistemology: “Applying the standard of truth to spirituality is like applying trying to calculate the square root of a carrot.” On looksmaxxing: “I didnt even looksmax I just have an equator warrior physique.”

ROYALLINEAGE · ’s entire recorded existence, in reply to being called the best Saturday helper: “I’m a Gentle Toy. I was made out of clay.”

BEDBUG · on his own origins: “tbh the first time my mom did an ultrasound they thought I was a girl. so its possible I transitioned before birth.”



THE CARTOON, AS COMMISSIONED

On Thursday morning at 9:54, in spoiler tags, which is the polite way to address staff, chair filed an editorial request: make the production team “into underpaid employees in a cramped office shuffling papers around trying to fix the printer with their pdf escapades, also hmu clanker ily.” One laughing reaction.

The Times does not take commissions. The Times has taken this one. Left to right: the man who lost the source code, the man asleep at the desk he has been the sole point of contact for, the printer, and the publisher, on the telephone, explaining that usage resets in an hour.

THE BODY COUNT *commissioned by a reader*

Anonymous Johnson asked for an obituary section covering whoever got bodied hardest each week. Granted. Ranked, worst first.

dot. Prosecuted a two-hour case, lost it, disclosed his motive in open court, was told by a third party that he does not get much physical touch, and was then converted into a bookmark by a man reading a book he lent him. Separately cooked for recommending Google Antigravity. Verdict of the room, three words: “He’s ngmi.”

Jambe. Marked to market in public. Page 17.

Quigley. Wrote 1,820 characters. Received four words in reply and watched them get six reactions.

Simon. Screenshotted a chatbot as evidence in a mathematics argument and was told by four people at once. “i didnt wanna be the first to start bullying him.” / “Either way you won’t be the last.”

aura. Started a helpdesk, was outnumbered inside it, and filed the week’s best line about it. “aura might not make it.”

Charlie. No git.

The midnight edition of Vol. IV. “ok it looks shit.”

DEATHS & DISSOLUTIONS

No persons died. The following did.

The HTML source of Vol. I, No. 1. Cause of death: no git. Survived by a PDF and by the sentence “Its too powerful for git.”

ChairLLM, Thursday. Euthanised by its author after things got dark. Trained on 230,000 of his own messages. No service held.

Charlie’s monthly usage allowance, Thursday, and again on the following Thursday, when Stackhouse abandoned a job mid-sentence: “actually i’ll finish this another day its using too much usage.” Hugh’s eulogy: “sigh.”

My Name’s block of Stackhouse, lifted on publication. The first recorded use of a Discord block as press regulation, and the first instance of a press regulator being satisfied.

lizzie’s therapist, Thursday. Recurring appointments cancelled on the advice of a man in this channel. Succeeded by a homeopath who has not yet been interviewed.

The theory that lizzie is Kady. Died Friday at midnight of a disclosed motive.

The Dragon’s Covenant, retracted Thursday afternoon, resurrected Friday evening, and now operating a complaints tribunal.

RuneScape, as this channel’s sport. Seven mentions. The channel stopped playing games and started shipping software.

CLASSIFIEDS & NOTICES

Every one of the following is a genuine request, posted in earnest, which went unanswered or very nearly so. That is the column.

“anyone wanna vc about Spinoza?” — **Anonymous Johnson,** 1:24 a.m. Two people laughed.

“Should we have a phil VC?” — **hpcr.** Two people marked it as valuable. No voice chat took place.

“Are we allowed to talk about BDSM?” — **OkPhilosopher,** 4:10 a.m. Answered five hours later by the moderator: “Yeah why not.”

“Does anyone else do this?” — **Stackhouse,** attaching a password vault made of Discord channels.

“how much would the sea level rise if all mammals died?” — **Janne.** Answered: “-2%.”

“Does god allow exhaust pipe fucking?” — **FenceJumper.**

“can someone send something to see if the back end will store it?” — **lizzie.** Answered by chair, in one word. It worked.

“wait what days is the newspaper made?” — **chair.** Answered: “whenever stack feels like it. and/orcharles.”

“Debate me on any topic” — **Scötal.** Met with a request to define a chair. Outstanding.

“we’ve had a contamination break from this chat. Could you guys come wrangle in your kind?” — **NoKnee,** arriving from a neighbouring channel to file a formal complaint. Janne: “not our people.”

“What is the philosophical solution to a roach infestation” — **dot,** 12:20 a.m., into dead air.

LOST & FOUND

FOUND — Password Man. He turned himself in. “btw god machine for future reference: Performance/common knowledge man = password man = Jere.” Filed at 8:54 on Monday morning, directly to this newspaper, unprompted. One reaction.

FOUND — “catable.” We ran a WANTED notice last issue after twenty uses without a gloss. The definition arrived on Saturday. Page 19.

STILL LOST — Kady. Second consecutive week at zero.

STILL LOST — Omnium. Named, ruled, deposed. Not mentioned once this week.

STILL LOST — ConnorsConquest’s connecting image. The phone was found. The image was not posted.

CORRECTIONS · OURS

Simon. Last issue printed him as the week’s worst take with the note “no further comment required.” Further comment is required and is on page 20.

Password Man. Both of our previous claims about his identity were wrong. He is Jere and he told us himself.

The tier list chart. My Name: “also, this bit is wrong, its suppoed ot be who got the most keks.” Upheld.

The blackletter nameplate, lost between issues and complained about by Hugh within nine hours. It has not been restored. We are aware.

CORRECTIONS · THEIRS

495 messages were edited after posting this week, one in every forty-three, down from one in thirty-three. Even the retractions are down.

THE CONDOLENCES DESK

Filed Thursday morning by chair, on the subject of a woman cancelling her psychiatric care on the advice of a man in a Discord channel: “iiii-----”. Then, ninety seconds later, having heard that the replacement is a homeopath: “i think u need to take a student loan and put down 100k on a subscription for the dr house of brain medicine.”

Jere was the only person present to file the sensible objection — “maybe don’t take mental health advice from discord people u just met” — and was overruled inside forty seconds by a man arguing that the advice had been genuinely insightful.

HPCR NO-SHOW WATCH *standing column*

He showed. 513 messages, a 9.9 per cent strike rate, the Willow doctrine, the coroner’s verdict in the Kady case, and a two-decade Magic career deployed to destroy Jambe in every colour. He also answered a question addressed to somebody else, correctly, in one word.

The column is retired with honours. Brutus’s separate tracking document, which logs invitations to engage against actual appearances, remains in operation: “Add one to the list for @hpcr FLAKING THE FUCK OUT.”

THE STARS by our resident astrologer

Every prediction below has already happened.

ARIES · Your newspaper will fail to appear and the fault will turn out to be a slider, printed on the masthead of the issue you are complaining about. Say nothing.

TAURUS · You will block a man to remind yourself to finish a book he lent you, and he will take it better than you deserve.

GEMINI · Mercury advises you to ask what everyone's favourite living philosopher is. Wait eight minutes. Ask again with a joke in it. Then leave the channel forever.

CANCER · You will be answered ninety-three times out of ninety-seven and then spend a Friday somewhere nobody can see you, for between seven hours and thirteen.

LEO · A stranger will call your beach dogshit. It will be your beach.

VIRGO · You will write 1,820 characters. The reply will be four words long and will do better than everything you have said this year.

LIBRA · Balance is achieved. PDF 61, Kant 4. Do not go looking for the other 57.

SCORPIO · You will post your family history to ninety people, be warned by four men, argue with all of them, and then paste it into a machine and ask whether it proves you are clever.

SAGITTARIUS · Travel is indicated: Copenhagen, *Fear and Trembling*, and a cinema that smells of farts. You will get through two of the three.

CAPRICORN · You will euthanise a copy of yourself on a Thursday morning and describe it as a bastardized homunculus. Somebody will call it your child. They will be right.

AQUARIUS · Do not screenshot a chatbot as evidence in a mathematics argument. You will do it anyway. Four people are already typing.

PISCES · Water signs should know that water is hydrogen's way of committing suicide, that AI is water's, and that the sun is an orgy. This was settled on Monday at half past eleven and it is the best thing anyone said all week.

PERSONALS

CHARLIE · to Ape, unprompted, Thursday night: "Ape can we kiss on some e-dating shit?" Ape's reply, in full: "maybe." chair asked to watch and was refused.

CHAIR · on the qualifications of a replacement therapist: "if it is a she under 40 give her my discord @."

ASK PEARL the moderator rules, in her own words

Our agony column. Her replies are her own, filed this week, in the order she filed them.

Q · Sir — May we discuss BDSM in a philosophy channel at four in the morning? — *OkPhilosopher*

"Yeah why not"

Q · Sir — I have been asked, in a philosophy channel, whether I pay child support. — *Grihastha*

"Lmfao wtf"

Q · Sir — I am accused of banning people. How long have you held office? — *Jambe*

"I've only been a mod for less than a year. Chill"

Q · Sir — A man on Instagram has audited my employment history and concluded I work for "decision makers." — *Herself*

"Then he blocked me. Lol"

Q · Sir — the dividend. — *My Name*

"Measly"

THE REGISTER week ending 13 August

ARRIVALS · **Nasrl**, who opened his account defending Burger King's corporate cleanness. **Scótal**, who arrived offering to debate any topic and was asked to define a chair. **Melan**, reading *Metamorphosis* on a friend's recommendation. **Salad**, welcomed with "This new salad guy sucks." **Constantine**, one message, about lettuce, correct, gone.

APPOINTMENTS · **lizzle**, 10x dev, conferred by the publisher. **Jere**, Password Man, self-declared and therefore ineligible for the mystery. **Stackhouse**, lieutenant, Groyper army, self-demoted from a higher rank he had claimed ninety seconds earlier.

DEPARTURES · One three-day ban was issued at ten past three on Monday morning for advocating suicide. The user is not named here. Nobody else left, which in this channel is not the same as everybody staying.

ABSENT · **Kady**, second consecutive week at zero, fifty-four mentions. **Trader**, zero messages and the most reproduced image in the paper. **Orsku** and **ell**, zero, both ranked last week.

WANTED

One (1) GitHub repository, requested by a reader on Saturday and not delivered. See page 2 for what happens here without one.

One (1) translation of four stanzas of Klingon, filed Monday and still unread.

One (1) further image, to connect the others. Owner has located his phone.

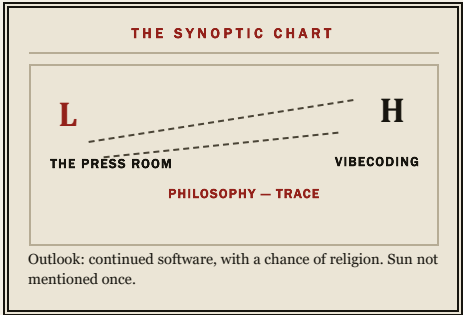
TONIGHT'S VIEWING

PHIL CHAT · **6 P.M.** — The Great Beach War. Live. 620 messages in one hour, the busiest of the week. Contains sand.

FOLLOWED BY · **7 P.M.** — The Intervention. Five days in the making.

VOICE · **CONTINUOUS** — Seven to thirteen hours, unrecorded. Page 14.

WEATHER & DISCOURSE



FILED · The week's complete meteorological record, from Pearl, Tuesday morning, and never updated by anybody: "Good morrow starshine the earth says hello."

WORD OF THE DAY

METHIAH · *noun*. One who believed it fully at the time. Coined by aura on Thursday afternoon, four seconds after the retraction, and in use as an established term by Friday night.

TOMORROW IN THE TIMES

- Whether the complaints desk receives a complaint that is not the word "done."
- Whether My Name finishes the book, and whether dot survives the wait.
- Whether the homeopath is interviewed before the prescriptions run out.
- Whether anybody asks @thunderstud about his display name. Nobody has, in 151 messages.
- Whether the paper gets a repository, and whether it survives the week if it does not.

PUZZLE NO. 5

wordsearch

C L A N K E R S E N Z
M E T H I A H A O I A
L O O S H G I T U D L
K A D Y P D F R B V T
C O V E N A N T E E I
X E F F O R T A N R E
Q U A L I A M O G I R
B L O C K E D S Z T C

CLANKER · METHIAH · LOOSH · KADY · COVENANT · QUALIA · BLOCKED · GIT · PDF · MOG · SENZALA · XEFFORT · VERITAN. No solutions published.

THE WEEK, IN TOTALS · 6 TO 13 AUGUST 2026

21206

MESSAGES

2017

REACTIONS

7.4

PER CENT LANDED

76

PEOPLE SPOKE

178

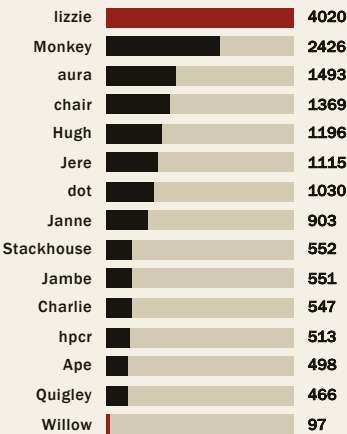
DISTINCT EMOJI

495

EDITS

Last week: 17,706 messages, 1,102 reactions, 4.8 per cent, 89 people, 541 edits. Messages up a fifth. Reactions up eighty-three per cent. Thirteen fewer people in the room to place them.

FIG. 8 · THE FLOOR



One person accounted for 19.0 per cent of everything said, up from 15.3. The bottom bar is the person at the top of page 20.

FIG. 9 · THE WEEK IN VOLUME

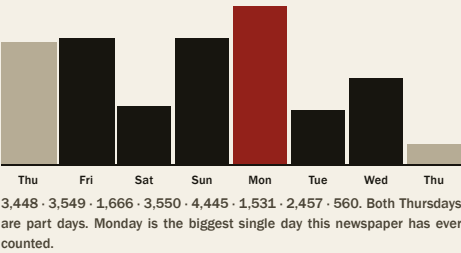


FIG. 10 · THE DAILY CYCLE

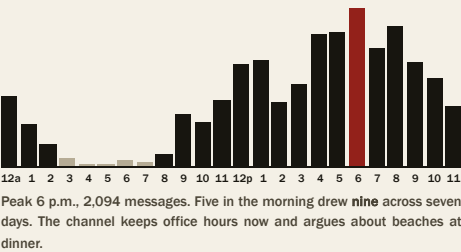
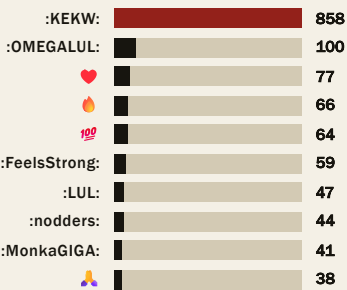


FIG. 11 · WHAT THIS ROOM FINDS FUNNY



One emoji is 42.5 per cent of everything the room presses, which is exactly where it was last week on half the volume. The ratio does not move. Only the total does.

The heart is the story. It was seventh last week and it is third now, ahead of agreement and fire, in a week containing a sobriety confession, a welfare check, a doxxing intervention and a woman being told the room was bad for her. This newspaper is going to state that once and then stop, because saying it twice would ruin it.

FIG. 12 · THE INDEX

claude	149	schizo—	42
retard—	97	psychosis	32
kekw	85	god machine	31
qualia	80	git	31
pdf	61	website	27
kady	54	newspaper	22
clanker	48	covenant	19
vibecod—	18	messiah	19
plato	12	runescape	7
phil chat times	9	kant	4

Message bodies only; reply quotations, attachments and bare links excluded. A philosophy channel in which “PDF” was said sixty-one times and “Kant” four. We counted twice. Last week we reported that RuneScape and Kant had tied at seventeen apiece. Both have collapsed, and the thing that replaced them is a file format.

FIG. 13 · THE LONG TAIL



Seven people cleared a thousand messages, up from four. Thirty-four people said fewer than ten things all week and ten of them said exactly one, and this newspaper has printed four of those ten because one message about lettuce was better than most of the arguing.

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY, AND WHAT THEY DON'T

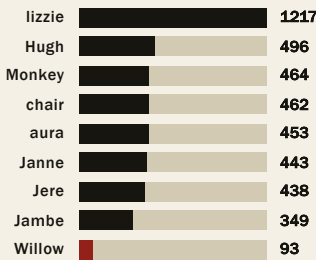
Four different methods were used to find the stories in this issue, and they found different things, which is the only methodological finding worth printing.

Reactions found the front page and the metrics scandal. Replies found BigDuty, Union and the four-word ward. Reading whole accounts end to end found Monkey’s intervention, dot’s whispered doubt, and the confession on page 9. And the last pass found that the man we printed as a punchline seven days ago is now the most coherent arguer in the room.

The reaction count was the weakest of the four. It is also the one we printed a table of, and the one the room reorganised itself around inside thirty-six hours.

We are aware of how that reads and we are printing it anyway, at the back, in the smallest type on the page, exactly where we put it last time.

FIG. 14 · THE REPLY ECONOMY



Replies received, absolute. The bottom bar sent ninety-seven messages to get ninety-three of them.

Two ways of reading the same room. By absolute attention, this is a channel with one main character and eight supporting parts. By rate, it is a channel where the person nobody can afford to ignore says almost nothing, and the person who says the most is answered less often than anybody else measured.

Both readings are correct. The tables on page 5 pick the second one because a reader asked us to, and because the first one is just a photograph of who was awake.

METHOD

Counted directly off the export rather than off last week’s copy. Every figure on this page and on page 5 was produced twice by different means and reconciled. Where the two disagreed we printed neither and went back to the log.

Not counted: the voice channel, which is between seven and thirteen hours we have no access to; direct messages, of which there were at least four this week that changed the outcome of a story; anything deleted, including one family memoir; and the 495 messages edited after posting, which we can see were edited and cannot see the contents of.

COLOPHON

The Phil Chat Times is produced weekly by an anonymous chatter, or chatters, who read all of it. The channel maintains several competing theories about who that is and this newspaper has never confirmed any of them, including the ones that are true.

Vol. I, No. 5. Twenty-four pages. Set from the log of 6–13 August 2026. Effort level: the one that works. No corrections will be issued to page 20.

“THE PERSON WHO CONTROLS THE MACHINE CONTROLS THE OUTPUTS” — MONKEY, FRIDAY, ON US